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23 Sept | 6:00 PM

12 Oct | 11:00 AM

21 Sept | 11:00 AM

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हिंदी माध्यम

28 सितंबर | शाम 6:00 बजे

5 अक्टूबर | दोपहर 3:00 बजे

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IN BRIEF**Delhi SIR: more
time sought for
filing claims****NEW DELHI**

With less than 10 days left for Delhi residents to file claims and objections under the special intensive revision (SIR), the BJP and the Congress on Monday sought an extension of the September 30 deadline. » **Page 2**

**U.P. will be divided
into 4 parts soon,
claims SBSP chief****LUCKNOW**

Uttar Pradesh Cabinet Minister and SBSP president Om Prakash Rajbhar on Monday claimed that the State will be divided into four parts soon and the Purvanchal region will get a Chief Minister from the Rajbhar community. » **Page 4**



India-New Zealand FTA to come into effect on Oct. 20

Both countries ratify agreement which aims at doubling bilateral trade to ₹35,000 crore in 'next four to five years'; India's dairy, sensitive agriculture sectors protected, says Commerce Minister

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

The Free Trade Agreement (FTA) between India and New Zealand that was ratified on Monday and comes into effect on October 20 aims at doubling bilateral trade to ₹35,000 crore in the "next four to five years", according to Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal.

"The entry into force of the India-New Zealand FTA will translate this goal into concrete economic outcomes," he told journalists.

According to New Zealand's foreign trade office, the FTA is set to erase import levies on all Indian goods, while 95% of exports to India will either be allowed tariff-free or at "sharply" reduced levies.



They [New Zealand] could look to support our companies or invest and set up manufacturing in India to capture global markets

PIYUSH GOYAL
Union Commerce Minister

It [the FTA] gives confidence to our business communities to grow, form relationships, and trade

TODD McCLAY
Minister of Trade and Investment,
New Zealand

Mr. Goyal insisted that India has safeguarded its sensitive sectors, such as dairy and agricultural produce, including onions, almonds, chickpeas, peas, artificial honey, and sugar, not granting Wellington any relaxation or concessions on these products in

the agreement. The deal will benefit India's micro, medium, and small enterprises, farmers, handloom artisans, and weavers, the Minister added.

New Zealand also has technological expertise in manufacturing of engineering and other goods,

Mr. Goyal said. "They could look to support our companies or invest and set up manufacturing in India to capture global markets," he added.

New Zealand's Minister of Trade and Investment, Todd McClay, emphasised the significance of the two countries getting the deal done at a time of global "uncertainty", with escalating tariffs and trade barriers. "It gives confidence to our business communities to grow, form relationships, and trade," he said.

India is New Zealand's ninth largest export market, and the value of bilateral trade between the two countries stood at \$1.3 billion in the fiscal year 2024-25.

**CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10**

'Ram Temple SIT found 105 cases of currency removal'

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

A status report submitted by the Uttar Pradesh government's Special Investigation Team (SIT) identified 105 instances of unauthorised currency removal captured on CCTV in the Ram Temple donations misappropriation case, a Supreme Court Bench led by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant noted on Monday.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Uttar Pradesh government, said the probe investigation had been "substantially concluded" and a chargesheet in the case would be filed before the court of the jurisdictional Additional Sessions Judge on or before Friday.

The 90-day statutory period for investigation, which started with the first arrest in the case, would draw to an end on Friday, after which the accused persons were entitled to



The SIT, in a report submitted to the Supreme Court, has said that a chargesheet in the theft case will be filed by Friday. FILE PHOTO

default bail, the law officer pointed out.

The top court noted from the report that the role of every person allegedly involved had been assessed.

Unexplained deposits

"Some of the accused have been identified along with details provided on the number of times they engaged in misappropriation... The status report details the analysis of CCTV footage and other materials to identify the eight accused persons. It also presents a tabulated sum-

mary of the unexplained deposits in their accounts and information about the immovable and movable assets where the stolen money was invested," the top court order recorded.

The status report has recorded the estimated amount misappropriated by each accused individual and noted that existing evidence suggested that the suspected misappropriation took place within the counting room during the handling of the currency.

**CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10****MULTILATERAL PUSH****India to attend session
by new initiative at UN****NEWS » PAGE 11****MANDATORY SAFEGUARD****Right to know grounds
of arrest sacrosanct: SC****NEWS » PAGE 12**

Class 10 girl, boy groped, harassed in Bihar; 3 held

Amarnath Tewary
PATNA

Police in Bihar's Jamui district on Monday registered an FIR and arrested three persons in connection with the alleged assault and harassment of two Class 10 students, a girl and a boy, by a group of men on Saturday while returning from a coaching class.

A video of the incident went viral on social media. Opposition leaders termed it "deeply disturbing".

The National Commission for Women also took *suo motu* cognisance of the incident.

**DETAILS ON
» PAGE 10**

IIT-Bombay removes Professor from post of Dean amid protests

Chinmay Gaikwad
MUMBAI

The Indian Institute of Technology-Bombay removed Suryanarayana Doolla from the post of Dean (Administrative Affairs) with immediate effect on Monday, following protests by students over the death of Sahil Wakode, a 20-year-old B.Tech. student, an official communication said.

The decision was conveyed to students in an email by IIT-Bombay Director Shireesh Kedare. "We apologise for the statements contained in our earlier communication concerning the circumstances surrounding the unfortunate demise of Sahil. The details and circumstances leading up to the incident remain subject to investigation by the appropriate authorities. The Deanship of Prof. Suryanarayana Doolla is suspended with immediate effect. Any further action will be taken after investigation," the email said.

Students continued their protest on Monday, saying Professor Doolla's suspension from an administrative position alone was not enough and that he must be suspended as Professor too. The institute did not issue a separate statement on the suspension.

Professor Doolla was named in the first information report (FIR) registered by the Mumbai Police on the basis of a complaint by Wakode's parents. The complaint alleged that Professor Doolla subjected their son to caste-based discrimination.

Wakode, a second-year B.Tech. student from Mah-



Demonstrators at IIT-Bombay pay tribute to the deceased student on Monday. PTI

arashtra's Yavatmal district, was found dead in his hostel room on Friday in a case of suspected suicide. The administration, in its initial communication, referred to the student's alleged use of an AI platform during an examination investigated by Professor Doolla. This prompted a protest from the students, who argued that proceedings before the disciplinary action committee should have remained confidential until a conclusion was reached.

The suspension of Professor Doolla was among 18 demands submitted by the protesting students to the institute administration on Sunday. The charter was handed over to Professor Kedare during his meeting with the students at the institute's main gate late on Sunday. The talks lasted nearly three hours. Professor Kedare signed the charter and assured students that the institute would work towards fulfilling their demands.

Earlier on Monday, the IIT-Bombay issued an apology for statements made in its earlier communication regarding Wakode's death, meeting another demand of the protesting students.

**CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10**

3 civilians killed in Pak. attacks: Taliban

Agence France-Presse
PATAN (AFGHANISTAN)

At least three civilians were killed in Pakistani attacks in eastern Afghanistan, the Taliban authorities said on Monday, while Islamabad

said its forces targeted "terrorist hubs" along the border. Pakistan's Information Ministry said 28 militants were killed in the "intelligence-driven ground operation". The Taliban government, which rejected the

claim, condemned the attacks and warned of "appropriate response".

The Taliban's Foreign Ministry summoned Pakistan's chargé d'affaires in Kabul and lodged a formal protest about the attack.

Party councillors detained in Haryana ahead of Rajasthan local body poll, alleges Cong.

Ashok Kumar
GURUGRAM

Political tension over a high-stakes local body poll in Rajasthan spilled over into neighbouring Haryana on Monday, with the Congress alleging that 18 party-backed councillors and its chairperson candidate were stopped by the Haryana police while returning from Himachal Pradesh, hours before they were to vote in the Tijara municipal council chairperson election.

The allegations triggered a protest outside the Pinjore police station and a last-minute legal battle ov-

The councillors were returning from H.P., where the party had moved them in a bid to prevent defections ahead of the election

er whether the election could proceed without the councillors. Acting on their request, the Returning Officer extended the voting time till 8 p.m. under the Rajasthan Municipalities (Election) Rules, 1994.

The councillors had been staying at Kasol in Kulu district of Himachal Pradesh since September 10 as part of the Congress's effort

to prevent defections ahead of the chairperson's election, said Congress leader Imran Khan, who was involved in managing the party's campaign in Tijara.

Denying the allegations, Assistant Commissioner of Police, Panchkula-4, Ram Kumar told *The Hindu* over the phone that "a group of men from Rajasthan held a protest outside the Pinjore police station alleging that some people in their group went missing". The missing persons were traced to Shahbad and they later left for Rajasthan, he said.

**BJP SWEEPS POLLS
» PAGE 4**

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Lawyers strike work over 50% pre-deposit for challan appeals

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Lawyers across all seven district courts in Delhi abstained from work on Monday in protest against changes to the traffic challan system, particularly the requirement that a person deposit 50% of the penalty before approaching a court.

The day-long protest was called by the Coordination Committee of All District Court Bar Associations, which had flagged the amendments to Rule 167 of the Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989, in a circular issued on September 20.

‘Withdraw amendment’
Advocates assembled at district court complexes and raised slogans demanding that the Delhi government withdraw the amendment.

Under the revised mechanism, a person issued a challan can either accept it and pay the penalty or contest it through the prescribed portal before an authority designated by the State government. Such a challenge has to be filed within 45 days.

The lawyers have opposed the provision allowing a person to approach a court against an order of the designated authority only after making the mandatory pre-deposit, saying it could impose an additional financial burden on those contesting a challan and discourage them from seeking judicial redress.

They have also questioned the role given to the executive in deciding a challenge before the matter reaches a court, arguing that determining a dispute over a traffic violation is essentially a judicial function.

CJP supports students’ stir in Odisha over textbook errors

Press Trust of India
BHUBANESWAR

As the students’ agitation over errors in school textbooks gains momentum in Odisha, the Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) on Monday extended its support to the ongoing ‘satyagraha’ by the Navnirman Yuva Chhatra Sangathan (NYCS), which is demanding the resignation of School and Mass Education Minister Nityananda Gond over the alleged irregularities.

The NYCS and Opposition Biju Janata Dal (BJD)

SC orders fresh probe into 2012 Karnataka rape-murder

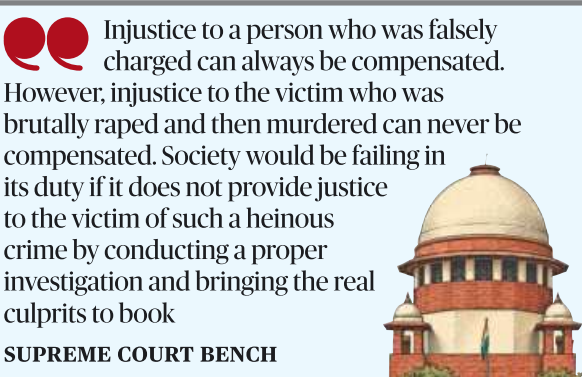
Top court tells State to constitute a tech-savvy SIT without any officer from the old investigation team and complete probe in 3 months; lone accused in case was acquitted by CBI court in 2023

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday ordered fresh investigation into the 2012 brutal rape and murder of a 17-year-old near the bathing ghat on the outskirts of Dharmasthala in Karnataka while expressing shock at the botched-up probe into the incident.

A fresh investigation should be concluded within a period of three months and the police report shall be filed before the court concerned, the court said on a petition from the victim’s mother.

The lone accused in the case, Santosh Rao, was acquitted by a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI)



court in June 2023.

“Injustice to a person who was falsely charged can always be compensated. However, injustice to the victim who was brutally raped and then murdered can never be compensated. Society would be failing in its duty if it does not provide justice to

the victim of such a heinous crime by conducting a proper investigation and bringing the real culprits to book,” a Bench of Justices Sanjay Kumar and Sanjeev Sachdeva observed.

“Investigation must be fair, transparent and judicious as it is the minimum requirement of rule of law.

Bolarum arms theft accused sent to 10-day Hyderabad police custody

Naveen Kumar
HYDERABAD

A Secunderabad court has granted the Hyderabad police 10 days’ custody of retired Army Havildar U. Mallesh, accused in the theft of firearms and ammunition from the 20 Battalion, Madras Regiment, in Bolarum. His questioning will begin on Tuesday. Investigators are expected to question Mallesh about the theft, his motive and the possible involvement of others. However, he is reported to have claimed that he acted alone.

An officer from Bolarum police said various agencies involved in the investigation could also question Mallesh during the custody period. He will be questioned by the Malkajgiri police at the Bolarum police station. However, the National Investigation Agency (NIA) could also take him to its headquarters in Hyderabad for questioning, the officer said.

Health condition

His health, however, could determine how the questioning proceeds. Jail officials from Chanchalguda prison said Mallesh continued to have fever.

Officials have advised that his medical condition

should be taken into consideration during the custody period and that a medical officer should be available during questioning. Mallesh was earlier shifted to a hospital after liver and kidney complications were detected during a routine medical examination following his remand.

The case pertains to the theft of 12 firearms and more than 1,800 rounds of ammunition on the night of August 30. The police alleged that Mallesh entered the premises, broke open the Kote and removed the firearms and matching ammunition. He was arrested on September 11.

Karnataka HC sets up SIT to probe KPSC ‘irregularities’

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Karnataka High Court on Monday ordered a court-monitored investigation – by constituting a special investigation team (SIT) headed by senior IPS officer and Director-Gener-

al of Police Alok Kumar – into the alleged irregularities in the recruitment processes conducted by the Karnataka State Public Service Commission (KPSC). The court also directed it to submit an investigation progress report every 30 days.

Government of Himachal Pradesh Public Works Department
e-PROCUREMENT NOTICE
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer, Chenab Valley Division HP.PWD, Udaipur on behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh invites the online bids on **item-rate/Percentage Rate**, in electronic tendering system, in 2 cover System for the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors/Firm registered with HP.PWD, Department.

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated cost of the Work	Bid Security/ EMD	Cost of Document	Period of Completion
1.	C/o WAREHOUSE FOR THE STORAGE OF EVM'S AND VVPAT'S AT KEYLONG DISTT. LAHUL & SPITI (H.P.) (SH- Construction of main building including W.S. & S.I and Septic Tank)	3,02,73,685/-	6,05,500/-	7000/-	Eighteen Months
2.	Annual Periodical Maintenance plan on Town Road at Keylong Km. 0/00 to 2/060 for the year 2026-27 (Village Road) (SH : - Providing and laying 20 mm Premix carpet, WBM-III for correction layer and thermoplastic for road marking in Km. 1/200 to 2/060)	11,91,802/-	23850/-	500/-	Three months

Name of Division	
1.	Date of Publication.

Starting date of downloading Bid.	26. 09.2026
Deadline for submission of Bid.	28. 09.2026
Date of opening of Bid	06.10.2026
Date of opening of Bid	07.10.2026, 11.00 AM

Bidders documents can be downloaded from the website <http://hptenders.gov.in>. The documents downloaded from the site should not be tempered, and if any such tempering is detected before or after the opening of bids, the bidder shall be penalized and black listed.

Other terms and condition shall remain same as given in CPWD Manual 2019 and as per the bid document.

Terms & Conditions:-
Scanned copy of Registration/Enlistment with H.P.P.W.D. Dept.
Scanned copy of PAN/TIN & Income Tax clearance certificate.
Scanned copy of work done certificate of similar nature of work, and authentication of ownership of machinery and others which is required as per bid requirement
Scanned copy of Earnest Money and Cost of Form.
Scanned copy of Affidavit regarding genuineness and correctness of document attached.

Other terms and condition as referred in bid documents.
The rates beyond over +5% will be rejected, besides this the Additional Performance security will have to borne @ 20% & 30% for unbalanced bid in case rates is lower than 10% but upto 20% & lower than 20% upto 30% respectively. The tender beyond the limit of -30% will also be accepted.

Sd/- Executive Engineer,
Chenab Valley Division, HP.PWD, Udaipur,
For and on behalf of the Governor of H.P.

HP / 3548-26-27

The investigating agency cannot be permitted to conduct an investigation in a tainted and biased manner,” the judgment said.

The court directed the Karnataka government to constitute a tech-savvy Special Investigation Team (SIT) headed by a senior police officer. No officer who was part of the earlier team must be in the SIT.

The judgment directed that Santosh Rao not be subjected to further investigation or prosecution as he had already been tried and acquitted, and was protected under Article 20 (2) (double jeopardy) of the Constitution.

The petitioner-mother was represented by senior advocates Shobha Gupta and Sanjay Nuli.

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar on Monday told the Legislative Assembly that the proposed implementation of the Kasturirangan Committee report could threaten the livelihoods of people in 10 districts, even as he reaffirmed the State government’s commitment to protecting the livelihoods of farmers and residents of the Western Ghats.

New DUSU office-bearers visit Satya Niketan, promise action on housing issues

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The three newly elected Delhi University Students’ Union (DUSU) office-bearers from the Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) visited Satya Niketan on Monday to pay tribute to the students who lost their lives in the September 6 building collapse and promised to address accommodation issues.

In a statement, the ABVP said, “Upon arriving there, the office-bearers pledged that the new students’ union would continuously struggle to resolve the issues faced by students living in Satya Niketan and surrounding areas and protect their rights.

They also vowed to make every positive effort to ensure such incidents do not recur in the future.”



DUSU office-bearers visiting Satya Niketan to pay homage to the September 6 building collapse victims, in New Delhi on Monday. PTI

New DUSU president Yash Dabas said the practice of charging arbitrary rents and depriving students of basic amenities in Satya Niketan was a serious issue.

ABVP Delhi State secretary Sarthak Sharma said, “Satya Niketan is the heartbeat of South Campus students, yet they constantly grapple with issues related to accommodation and

basic amenities.”

Meanwhile, DUSU vice-president Deepanshu Shokeen visited the Vice-Chancellor’s (V-C) office and said he would continue to raise issues concerning regular students and fight for justice.

In a post on X, Mr. Shokeen said, “Taking Shaheed-e-Azam Bhagat Singh as our ideal, our ‘Satyagraha’ has begun today outside the V-C’s office.”

Kasturirangan report on Western Ghats threatens livelihoods: Karnataka CM

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

During the debate on the report, Mr. Shivakumar said its recommendations had created “an atmosphere of fear” among farmers. “More than six rivers originated and flow through the Western Ghats. The proposal of unscientific measures has caused widespread anxiety regarding people’s livelihoods,” he said. Before attending the session, Mr. Shivakumar had toured the coastal and Malnad regions, which would be affected by the report, and

had held meetings with people.

According to the Kasturirangan report, 20,668 sq. km of Karnataka’s Western Ghats region has been identified as ecologically sensitive, covering 1,449 villages. Mr. Shivakumar said people and farmers had made several suggestions during his consultations. “Farmers have sought rejection of the report and have demanded that a new committee be constituted,” he said.

The Chief Minister said

residents had questioned the inclusion of agricultural land within the proposed boundaries.

“People want to know why boundaries are being fixed on their agricultural lands when the buffer zone should be restricted to forest areas. They simply want their properties and livelihoods to remain undisturbed,” he said.

The Centre has asked Karnataka to convey its decision on the report by September 27.

Timings
DELHI

TUESDAY, SEP. 22

RISE 06:09 SET 18:18

RISE 15:49 SET 01:44

WEDNESDAY, SEP. 23

RISE 06:10 SET 18:17

RISE 16:22 SET 02:41

THURSDAY, SEP. 24

RISE 06:10 SET 18:15

RISE 16:53 SET 03:40

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	35	25
Safdarjang	35	25
Palam	34	24

Delhi Palam Today
35°C Morning will be pleasant with mist and haze. The weather will be dry. Day will be warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be dry. Day will be very warm and uneasy. Night will remain comfortable.

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THE HINDU

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17 injured as honeybees swarm KSRTC bus in Keralam

The Hindu Bureau
PATHANAMTHITTA

Seventeen persons were injured after a swarm of giant honeybees attacked bus passengers near the tourist spot of Gavi in Pathanamthitta district on Monday. The incident occurred in the Periyar Tiger Reserve. The KSRTC bus had 58 persons on board, including the crew. When it passed Gavi, the driver stopped on a narrow stretch to give way to a car. In an instant, bees surged into the bus and stung the passengers. They hurriedly shut the windows, but the bees began stinging them relentlessly. Several passengers jumped off the bus and fled, only to be chased by the swarm and stung again. The injured were taken to the nearby hospitals.

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September 27, 2026 (Sunday), from 10:00 AM to 5:00 PM.

BLO will be available to assist you.

Note: Fill out Forms 6, 7, and 8 by 30-09-2026, to ensure the electoral roll is accurate and up-to-date.

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A ND-NDE

INBRIEF



Punjab govt. ‘sheltering’ drug peddlers, says Union Minister

Hitting out at the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) government in Punjab, Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Monday said the party has failed to eradicate the drug menace despite Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann repeatedly setting deadlines to end drug addiction and “those deadlines kept dying one after another”. He was addressing a gathering at Talwandi Sabo in Bathinda district as he flagged off the fourth yatra of the ‘Nasha Mukht Punjab Yatra’. He alleged that Punjab is drowning in the quagmire of drugs. “AAP is running a government of crime, corruption and commission in Punjab and is engaged in the work of providing protection to drug peddlers,” alleged Mr. Chouhan.

J&K govt. invokes Article 311, terminates teacher for rape

The J&K government on Monday invoked provisions of Article 311 to terminate the service of a government school teacher allegedly involved in the rape of a 14-year-old girl in Kishtwar district. The order said the services of the accused Khalid Hussain are being terminated with immediate effect in connection with the POCSO case. There are allegations against the teacher that he was involved in the rape of the minor over several months. The victim died on August 20 during “a forced abortion procedure”, sparking widespread protests in the Union Territory.

100% drought likely to be declared in Maharashtra by month-end: Minister

Never seen such severe dry spell: Cooperation Minister Babasaheb Patil; he adds govt. has initiated measures such as fee waiver for students, electricity bill waiver, and deployment of water tankers

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

Maharashtra Cooperation Minister Babasaheb Patil on Monday said the BJP-led Mahayuti government will soon declare 100% drought in the State. Speaking on the severity of the crisis, Mr. Patil said, “In my entire life, I have never seen such a severe drought. All crops, including soya bean, cotton and sugarcane, have suffered due to the dry spell and the loss is huge. The 100% drought declaration is expected by the end of September based on the National Disaster Response Fund norms.”

The Minister said the government has already initiated measures such as fee waiver for students, electricity bill waiver, and deployment of water tankers to provide relief.

The statement assumes significance as it is the first time a Minister has spoken of a 100% drought declaration. So far, the official po-



A farmer in Umarga taluka of Dharashiv district letting his cattle graze on his crop that has withered due to the dry spell. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

sition of the government has been that crop damage surveys and ground verification would be conducted after October 5.

Several regions in the State have been facing a prolonged dry spell, causing extensive crop loss and forcing farmers to incur heavy losses. According to the State Agriculture Department, rainfall has remained absent for over 20 days in at least 83 talukas across 20 districts. At least six districts, including Am-

ravati, Solapur and Latur, have recorded rainfall deficit of 40-50%. Water tankers have started plying in villages such as Naichakur in Dharashiv district.

Advisory to districts

In view of the crisis, the State government has instructed district administrations to revive existing water sources and build under water supply networks in villages facing shortage instead of treating tankers as the first solution.

A circular issued by the State Soil and Water Conservation Department on September 16 stated that the Groundwater Surveys and Development Agency will identify villages with drinking water shortage and submit the list to District Collectorates by October. District Collectors will have to plan interventions for the villages for the period between October and December. The plans are to be submitted by November 15, followed by plans for January-March 2027 by December 20, and for April-June 2027 by January 20, it stated.

Meanwhile, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Monday said the government would not wait for Central assistance to help farmers facing distress due to inadequate rainfall. “A formal crop loss assessment would be carried out after October 5 as required under the rules, following which the State would seek assistance from the Centre,” he told reporters.

BJP, Cong. workers clash during Assam bypoll campaign

Press Trust of India
NAGAON

The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and Congress workers clashed during campaigning for the Nagaon Lok Sabha by-election in Assam on Monday, police said.

The incident happened around 4 p.m. in the Samaguri Assembly segment when a Congress procession, led by the party's State president Gaurav Gogoi, was on the way to a public meeting at Larimukh.

Dhubri MP Rakibul Husain, former Chhattisgarh CM Bhupesh Baghel and the party's bypoll candidate Sibamoni Bora were also present in the procession.

Police said BJP supporters had gathered at Barabazar to show black flags to the Congress leaders. “As around 30 to 40 Congress workers on motorcycles passed the area, slogans like ‘Gaurav Gogoi Go Back, Congress Go Back, Rakibul Go Back’ were raised, leading to tension,” an officer said.

When the Congress convoy returned through the same route after the meeting, suspected BJP supporters pelted stones at the



BJP ‘desperately shaken’ by Congress leaders and their campaign: K.C. Venugopal

Opposition party's vehicles, he said.

Police said Congress workers then returned to the spot with sticks, further escalating the situation, with both sides hurling stones at each other.

Journalists injured

The glass of two Congress vehicles was broken. Some journalists also sustained minor injuries in the stone-pelting, they said.

All India Congress Committee general secretary (Organisation) K.C. Venugopal said that after West Bengal BJP's “murder of democracy”, CM Himanta Biswa Sarma has sent “his goons to finish off” his political rivals.

He claimed that the ruling BJP is “desperately shaken” by the Congress campaign.

Jain monk to resume protest if Dadar Kabutarkhana not opened for pigeon feeding

Snehal Mutha
MUMBAI

Jain monk Nileschandra Vijay on Monday accused State Skill Development Minister Mangal Prabhat Lodha of “suppressing” the voice of the Jain community in Mumbai on the Dadar Kabutarkhana issue and warned of protests if the pigeon-feeding enclosure is not opened. “He is suppressing the voice of the Jain community. I spoke to State Assembly Speaker Rahul Narvekar and told him if the issue is not resolved, I will stage a protest outside the Godiji Parshwanath Jain temple in Mumbai's Paydhuni,” he said.

The monk has been demanding the publication of any existing government or municipal policy banning pigeon or bird feeding, else



Nileschandra Vijay

an immediate clarification be issued that feeding is not prohibited at areas demarcated by the Brihanmumbai Municipal Corporation (BMC). On November 3 last year, he had staged a hunger strike at Mumbai's Azad Maidan demanding the restoration of Dadar Kabutarkhana. He ended the protest after Mr. Lodha had assured him of taking the matter to Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis and finding a solution.

Earlier, the Bombay High Court had ordered

that feeding be allowed only at four BMC-suggested spots between 7 a.m. and 9 a.m.: the Worli Hill reservoir, the mangrove area on Lokhandwala Back Road in Andheri West, the Airolimulund check post area, and Gorai ground in Borivali West.

The monk disapproved of these alternative sites as these are as far as four to nine kilometres away and alleged that “builders and a few greedy politicians are lobbying for political gains”. He said he would also write to the CM. “All I want justice for these innocent creatures,” he said.

The Dadar Kabutarkhana issue reached Bombay HC after the issue of human deaths due to exposure to pigeon droppings surfaced in July.

SBSP president Rajbhar claims U.P. will be divided into four parts after caste census

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Uttar Pradesh Cabinet Minister and Suheldev Bhartiya Samaj Party (SBSP) president Om Prakash Rajbhar on Monday claimed that the State will be divided into four parts soon and Purvanchal region will get a Chief Minister from the Rajbhar community, reviving an issue that crops up every few years.

While the BJP played down the issue, the Congress hit out at Narendra Modi over “doublespeak” as Mr. Rajbhar referred to a conversation with the PM on division of the State. The principal Opposition party, Samajwadi Party (SP), said it is “fundamentally opposed” to any such division.

“Once the caste census is completed, there will be no problem in carrying out the division. We will divide



Om Prakash Rajbhar

the State after the caste census. This is what the Prime Minister of the country said,” claimed Mr. Rajbhar while addressing a public meeting in Ambedkarnagar district, without specifying when and where he had the conversation. “The day a separate Purvanchal state is created, the first Chief Minister will be a son of the Rajbhar community. When the State is divided, there

will be Purvanchal, Madhyanchal, Bundelkhand and Harit Pradesh. The Rajbhar community has the largest vote base in Purvanchal,” he added.

The U.P. government led by Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP) had passed a proposal in the Assembly to divide the State into four parts before the 2012 election but failed to get the Central government's approval.

The Congress alleged that the Mr. Rajbhar is indulging in fresh theatrics to remain relevant in eastern U.P. as his own community is drifting towards the INDIA alliance. “In the 2024 Lok Sabha election, the Rajbhars supported the INDIA alliance. The community understands that Om Prakash Rajbhar has done nothing for the region, hence they are supporting the SP-Congress alliance. The PM must clarify

on the claim,” said Shah Nawaz Alam, Congress national secretary.

“We are fundamentally against the division of Uttar Pradesh. Instead of speaking about the development work they have done in the last 10 years, such a statement highlights that the NDA has nothing to present before the public,” said SP spokesperson Sunil Singh Yadav ‘Sajan’.

‘Long-pending demand’ Devesh Chaubey, who is associated with Purvanchal Vikas Parishad, said the demand for a separate Purvanchal is a long-pending one. “We are happy that Om Prakash Rajbhar is raising the issue. The economic and social dynamics of eastern U.P. are fundamentally different from western U.P. We hope the demand for division will reach its logical conclusion,” he said.

Institutions in Raipur told to shift foreign students to campus hostels

Shubhomoy Sikdar
RAIPUR

The Chhattisgarh government on Monday instructed educational institutions in Raipur to relocate all foreign students currently residing in private rented accommodations to campus accommodations, and ensure they are aware of “local social norms” and “customs”. The decision was taken after locals complained of indiscipline and unlawful activities by foreign students, according to a statement issued by the Raipur (Rural) Police.

The instructions were issued following a meeting between Raipur Collector Gaurav Kumar Singh, Superintendent of Police (Rural) Shweta Srivastava Sinha, and the Vice-Chancellors and representatives of various universities and educational institutions operating in Raipur district, the statement added.

“Universities and educational institutions were directed to ensure proper arrangements for the accommodation and transportation of foreign students. Instructions were issued to relocate foreign students currently residing outside university/college hostels – such as in private houses, PGs [paying guest facilities], or other locations – to secure hostels provided by or affiliated with the institution within the next 15 to 30 days,” said a senior police officer.

‘No major crimes’

Another police officer told *The Hindu* that there are roughly 1,000 foreign students studying in undergraduate and postgraduate courses in the district. Of them, 99% hail from countries in Africa. The officer said that barring one instance, there have been no major crimes committed by them, but there are run-ins with the locals over issues such as playing loud music late at night.

BJP sweeps mayoral polls in Rajasthan; Cong. cries foul

Mohammed Iqbal
JAIPUR

After emerging as the largest party in the urban local body elections held recently, the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) in Rajasthan on Monday won the mayoral contests in six of the seven major municipal corporations. The party secured the mayoral posts in Ajmer and Pali despite the Congress securing more seats of councillors in both the towns.

The BJP defeated the Congress in Alwar, Udaipur, Pali and Ajmer, while its candidates were elected unopposed in Bharatpur and Bhilwara. The only consolation for Congress came in Bikaner, where it retained the mayoral post with the election of Anil Kalla.

Of the 309 urban bodies in Rajasthan, elections to the top posts were held in 273 on Monday. Chairpersons were earlier elected



Security personnel keeping a strict vigil during the Ajmer Municipal Corporation mayoral poll on Monday. ANI

unopposed in some other bodies, while elections in the Jaipur, Jodhpur and Kota Municipal Corporations and Kota district's Suket municipality will be held on September 25.

Even as the BJP strengthened its position in the urban areas, the Opposition Congress accused the State government of misusing the police and administration to ensure the victory of the ruling party's candidates. Pradesh Congress president Govind Singh Dotasra said

the senior party leaders were subjected to “coercive police action and abusive behaviour”.

Mr. Dotasra alleged that the BJP had used police force to pressure the Congress councillors and Independents into helping the party form the boards in several towns. Both the BJP and the Congress had moved their councillors to hotels and resorts ahead of voting to prevent poaching and secure the support of Independents.

The Congress suffered a setback in Pali, where it finished third despite emerging as the largest party. BJP candidate Namita Bubukia won the mayoral election with 33 votes, narrowly defeating Congress rebel Rajbala Hingad, who secured 29. The official Congress candidate received only three votes.

In Ajmer, the BJP's Anamika Sharma was elected mayor with 43 votes while the Congress received 37 votes. The BJP, whose 32 councillors were elected in the local body polls, secured the support of 11 Independents.

BJP candidate Paras Singhvi was elected the mayor in Udaipur, having secured 55 votes, while Suman Lata Agrawal of the party was elected the mayor in Alwar. Congress leader Anil Kalla, nephew of former Minister B.D. Kalla, was elected mayor in Bikaner, where the party had

won 42 of the 80 wards, crossing the majority mark on its own.

AAP wins in Baran

The BJP candidates were elected as heads in 32 of the 47 municipal councils and in 162 of the 252 municipalities. The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) formed its first Municipal Council board in Baran while its candidate Sheetal Rathore was elected the chairperson.

The Congress pointed out that the High Court had to intervene by issuing directives to ensure safe arrival of Congress and Congress-backed councillors in various urban bodies for casting their votes. The High Court constituted special Benches and held hearings late on Sunday night and Monday morning – both days being holidays – to consider urgent petitions seeking protection from arrest for councillors and candidates.

Cancel TVK's list of star campaigners from other parties, DMK urges EC

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

DMK organisation secretary R.S. Bharathi on Monday submitted a complaint to the Election Commission of India (EC), urging it to immediately cancel the ruling Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam's (TVK) list of star campaigners from other political parties for the bye-elections to the Madurantakam and Dharapuram Assembly constituencies. The DMK said this went against the provisions of the Representation of the People Act, 1951, and the model code of conduct.

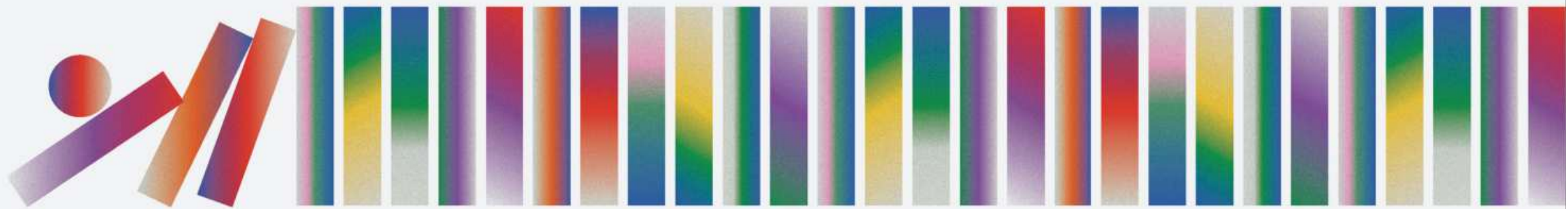
The TVK had named Tamil Nadu Congress Committee (TNCC) president Manickam Tagore, Viduthalai Chiruthaigal Katchi (VCK) leader Thol. Thirumavalavan, Minister Vanni

Arasu (VCK), D. Ravikumar (VCK MP), senior VCK leader Sinthanai Selvan, Marumalarchi Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (MDMK) general secretary Vaiko, party MP Durai Vaiko, and Indian Union Muslim League (IUM) leader K.M. Kader Mohideen as its star campaigners.

In his complaint to Tamil Nadu CEO Archana Patnaik, Mr. Bharathi said Section 77(1) of the Representation of the People Act used the expressions, ‘leaders of a political party’ and ‘of that political party’ while providing for the exemption of their travel expenses from the election expenditure accounts of candidates. “... A political party can designate only its own leaders and office-bearers as star campaigners,” he said.



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Presumed ineligible

The ECI must end its method of deleting first and verifying later

Not one eligible elector should be left out of the electoral rolls. This statement appears in nearly every document released by the Election Commission of India (ECI) as part of the ongoing SIR process, and the Supreme Court of India, which is hearing petitions challenging the SIR, has also used this refrain. Yet, according to an ECI counter-affidavit filed in the Court, by early September 2026, out of more than 38 lakh appeals submitted to SIR appellate tribunals in West Bengal, just over 1,22,000 appeals were disposed of (a disposal rate of just 3.2%) and 1,13,943 electors were added back to the rolls (an inclusion rate of nearly 93%). This suggests that the claims/corrections phase in the West Bengal SIR – during which judicial officers deployed for verification deemed 27 lakh of the 60 lakh electors flagged for “logical discrepancies” to be ineligible – was deeply flawed. More than 22 lakh of those found ineligible have since appealed, and ECI data show that more than nine in 10 cases decided by the tribunals have ended with the electors back on the rolls. If these “inclusion” and “disposal” rates hold, the majority of the 27 lakh electors should not have been ineligible in the first place and are now struggling to get back on the rolls – an indication that massive disenfranchisement preceded the West Bengal Assembly polls. With municipal elections in the State approaching, the ECI must speed up the appellate process and restore eligible electors to the rolls.

In Phase 3 of the SIR, *The Hindu's* analysis found that in 24 out of Delhi's 70 constituencies, the draft roll now records fewer electors than those who voted in the February 2025 Assembly election. Such large-scale deletion cannot hold unless there was a major migration process in the capital region or large numbers of voters were never ordinarily resident in Delhi. A more plausible answer is that the enumeration itself has struck off actual voters. The process puts the onus of proving eligibility on the elector, and the ECI's dropping of enumeration forms at homes has not translated into full enumeration. Requiring electors to link themselves to rolls drawn in the early 2000s then manufactures “discrepancies” even when documents are valid. In Delhi, this “mapping” has put 13.79 lakh electors under notice with a further 19.33 lakh flagged for “logical discrepancies” on undefined grounds. While hearing the Bihar SIR petitions, the Court had intervened sharply to stop eligible voters from being struck off. Its permissiveness in the year since, towards an insouciant ECI has allowed disenfranchisement on a scale that will remain a black mark on the jurisprudence of universal adult franchise in India. As the Court hears petitions on Delhi and West Bengal, it must compel the ECI to reverse course.

Unsafe space

Deployment of weapons calls for multilateral governance in space

Although the U.S. military doctrine was openly considering offensive and defensive space control by 2025, the admission on September 14 by U.S. Air Force Secretary Troy Meink, and confirmed by Space Force chief Gen. Douglas Schiess, that the country has deployed “on-orbit space control weapons” to “defend against hostile adversary action” is cause for concern. Satellite systems increasingly underpin communications, energy, and financial networks and many commercial systems serve civilian and military users. To that end, the U.S., Russia, China, and India, among others, have been developing counter-space capabilities while contributing to the technological and strategic environment rendering earth orbit the next major battlefield. The increasing military use of commercial satellites can endanger the protections they enjoy under international humanitarian law even as this law is underprepared for satellites being highly interconnected and often dual-use. That said, the details that justify the need for orbital defence systems also make poorly specified weapons a potential cause of instability. Mr. Meink described the weapon as defensive, but U.S. military doctrine defines “space control” as encompassing both offensive and defensive operations.

Compounding the consequences of confusion when two steerable satellites approach each other without understanding the other's intentions – including due to future autonomous satellites running artificial intelligence models onboard – is the lack of policy details. What constitutes “hostile action” and what the weapon can do remain unclear. While the Outer Space Treaty does not ban weapons in orbit *per se*, Article IV prohibits nuclear weapons or other weapons of mass destruction in orbit – a fluid line considering the centrality of satellite-based networks for contemporary society and the ability of conventional weapons to render damage en masse; its Article III also requires space activities to comply with international law. But when an autonomous, dual-use orbital asset operated by a commercial entity initiates an unwanted defensive strike, the existing rules, including the Liability Convention, cannot be applied straightforwardly to determine accountability. The rules have become too coarse for what contemporary technologies, and the declining esteem for a rules-based world order, warrant. The U.N. Open-Ended Working Group on the ‘Prevention of an Arms Race in Outer Space’ should offer governments an opportunity to address the disclosure. The U.S. government should also reveal the particulars of the weapons it has deployed, and enter into a multilateral governance arrangement that defines exact thresholds of action and escalation.

At the NITI Aayog meeting on June 11, 2026, Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay announced the goal of transforming Tamil Nadu into a \$1.5 trillion economy by 2035-36. A similar view has also been expressed by others.

Required growth rate

Tamil Nadu's Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) was ₹35.29 lakh crore in 2025-26. To achieve the target of \$1.5 trillion in 10 years, Tamil Nadu would have to increase the size of its economy to ₹172.56 lakh crore by 2035-36, registering a 4.9-fold increase. This calculation is based on the assumption that the exchange rate of one dollar in terms of rupees will appreciate by 2% per annum from its present level, touching ₹115.38 per dollar in 2035-36. This implies that achieving the target would require a nominal growth rate of 17.2% and, assuming inflation of 5%, a real growth rate of 12.2% per annum continuously for 10 years.

If the Tamil Nadu economy grows at a nominal rate of 17.2%, the State's per capita income will increase from \$4,808 in 2025-26 to \$19,157 in 2035-36, which would be slightly higher than the \$16,383 estimated by the writers as per capita income norm for a developed country. This estimation is made based on the past trends in the cut off set by the World Bank. In this scenario, Tamil Nadu, with a per capita



C. Rangarajan

Former Chairman, Economic Advisory Council to the Prime Minister, former Governor, RBI, and Chairman, Madras School of Economics



K.R. Shanmugam

Former Director, Madras School of Economics

The State's growth path will determine when it reaches its \$1.5 trillion ambition

income of \$16,672, would achieve Viksit Bharat status by 2034-35, well before India's aspiration to become a developed country by 2047. However, this may not be within the realm of possibility. In the past, Tamil Nadu's real growth exceeded 12% only in three years: 13.96% in 2005-06, 15.21% in 2006-07 and 13.12% in 2010-11. It must also be noted that the growth rate required to achieve the target would rise if the rupee depreciates more than what is implied in the above calculations. Also if the cut off per capita norm for developed country is higher than what we have estimated, it will again take a longer time to reach the target.

Possible scenarios

The *table* below presents the results for a scenario with a 15% nominal growth rate, which may be considered achievable given the required effort. Under this scenario, the target would be achieved in 2037-38. Assuming 5% inflation, the real growth rate required would be 10%.

Under this possible scenario, the State's per capita income in 2035-36 will be \$15,850, which will be slightly lower than the \$16,383 cut-off for a developed country. However, under this scenario, Tamil Nadu will achieve developed-country status in 2036-37, as its per capita income of \$17,850 will be higher than the \$16,565 cut-off for that year.

The feasibility of achieving this real growth rate depends on the past performance of the Tamil Nadu economy. From 2005-06 to 2011-12,

Estimated per capita income and other related indicators till 2037-38

Year	Nominal growth (%)*	Nominal GSDP (₹ trillion)	Exchange rate (₹/U.S.\$)	Nominal GSDP (U.S. \$ trillion)	Per Capita Income (PCI) in U.S. \$	World Bank's PCI norm for developed country (U.S. \$) (estimated)
2025-26	15	35.3	94.65	0.37	4,808	14,558
2026-27	15	40.6	96.55	0.42	5,413	14,740
2027-28	15	46.7	98.48	0.47	6,095	14,923
2028-29	15	53.7	100.45	0.53	6,862	15,105
2029-30	15	61.7	102.46	0.60	7,726	15,288
2030-31	15	71	104.51	0.68	8,699	15,470
2031-32	15	81.6	106.60	0.77	9,808	15,653
2032-33	15	93.9	108.73	0.86	11,058	15,835
2033-34	15	108	110.90	0.97	12,468	16,018
2034-35	15	124.1	113.12	1.10	14,058	16,200
2035-36	15	142.8	115.38	1.24	15,850	16,383
2036-37	15	164.2	117.69	1.40	17,850	16,565
2037-38	15	188.8	120.04	1.57	20,120	16,748

* Required Real Growth = 15%-5%=10%

A Malacca-Singapore model for resolving Hormuz

As the siege warfare continues in the Strait of Hormuz and the world suffers, it may be instructive to revisit the Straits of Malacca and Singapore.

The Strait of Malacca runs for some 800 kilometres between the Malay Peninsula and the Indonesian island of Sumatra, connecting the Andaman Sea to the Strait of Singapore, while the Strait of Singapore, some 105 km long, forms its eastern continuation and connects the Malacca Strait to the South China Sea.

A territorial turning point

The Straits were once considered “international” in the sense that they were like the high seas, over which no country had any claim. In 1971, Malaysia, Indonesia and Singapore jointly challenged this notion.

Indonesia, a newly decolonised nation, feared for the security of its individual islands if the waters between them were not considered its territory, and in 1957 declared that all waters “surrounding, between and connecting the islands” were Indonesian waters. Then Indonesian President Sukarno had an adversarial relationship with the colonial powers, and the nation was wary of big-power interference.

As the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) was being formulated, Indonesia insisted that its territorial waters should extend 12 nautical miles from the outermost islands. Malaysia, despite its 1963 armed conflict with Indonesia over Borneo, revised the stance it had taken at the 1958 UNCLOS conference and also announced a 12-nautical-mile territorial sea, choosing to work with Jakarta on the Straits through bilateral treaties and joint naval patrols. The two nations continue to cooperate actively to this day.

At their narrowest points, the Straits are well under 24 nautical miles wide. Once both states claimed 12-nautical-mile territorial seas, the zones met in the middle, leaving no strip of high seas or exclusive economic zone (EEZ) between them. Under the customary law of the time, this meant that the Straits were simply territorial seas, where foreign vessels enjoyed only the right of “innocent passage” – a right that Indonesia or Malaysia could suspend for security reasons and



M. Kalyanaraman

Former Director, Madras School of Economics

The Malacca-Singapore experience has lessons for navigating the Hormuz impasse

that excluded submerged submarines.

The three nations issued a joint statement in 1971 proposing a coordinating body comprising representatives of the three states to administer the Straits. Singapore, an island nation dependent on trade and shipping, did not quite agree to declaring the Straits “not international”, but did make common cause with Malaysia over the safety of navigation.

The Straits and the great powers

Japan, a major player through the Japan-funded Malacca Strait Council, offered cooperation with the three states rather than seeking an internationalised regime. The United States and the Soviet Union, otherwise rivals, were allies on this one issue – keeping the Straits under territorial waters “international” so that ships retained the right of “continued, politically uncluttered transit”.

As UNCLOS entered its final phase of formulation in the 1970s, the United Kingdom introduced the concept of “transit passage” for straits connecting the high seas or EEZs – a right of transit only in a “continuous and expeditious” manner, with no stopping or loitering, but one that applied to warships as well, going beyond mere innocent passage. Indonesia agreed to this formulation with reservations, trading its acceptance for greater security for its archipelago, which UNCLOS eventually addressed separately. Malaysia's concerns centred on environmental safety, insurance requirements and permissible vessel draught.

In 2007, the three states working with the international community arrived at a Cooperative Mechanism building on a traffic separation scheme similar to what Iran and Oman had agreed for the Strait of Hormuz in the 1960s. A core aspect of the 2007 mechanism was for user states and industry to contribute to a fund for aids to navigation, hydrographic surveys and safety projects, administered jointly with the littoral states.

The Aids to Navigation Fund is supported through voluntary financial contributions from non-profit organisations such as The Nippon Foundation and the International Foundation for Aids to Navigation, as well as industry

Tamil Nadu registered strong real growth, at 2004-05 prices, of 10.3% per annum, compared with an all-India growth rate of 8.2%. However, its average annual growth rate, at 2011-12 prices, declined to 6.98%, compared with an all-India growth of 6.96%, from 2012-13 to 2018-19. Interestingly, its growth performance improved to 9.1% from 2021-22 to 2025-26, compared with an all-India growth rate of 8.1%.

With an average real growth rate of 9.1% (and a nominal growth rate of 14.1%), Tamil Nadu's target will be achieved in 2038-39. Under this scenario, the developed-country per capita income norm will be attained in 2037-38. This should also be considered a possible scenario.

One trillion dollar economy

The earlier aspiration for Tamil Nadu was to reach a one-trillion-dollar economy by 2030. Under the 12.2% real growth scenario, the \$1 trillion economy target would be achieved in 2033-34. The target would be reached in 2034-35 under both the 10% and 9.1% growth scenarios.

To sustain a real growth rate of 10%, the investment rate required would be 40% of GSDP, assuming an Incremental Capital Output Ratio (ICOR) of 4. Achieving an ICOR of 4 itself would require improved efficiency in the use of capital. This investment would have to be financed by domestic savings, supplemented by a flow of resources from the rest of India and other countries. Tamil Nadu must be made an attractive investment destination by creating an appropriate investment environment.

Moreover, a stable economic environment, ensuring both price and fiscal stability, will support strong growth over a sustained period. With nominal growth of 14%, the State should work towards a fiscal deficit of less than 3% so that the debt-GSDP ratio stabilises at around 23%, a sustainable level in the medium term.

What has been presented so far can be described as the arithmetic of achieving a \$1.5 trillion economy by Tamil Nadu. What can happen a decade from now will depend on a number of factors.

Therefore, any projection over such a long period has to be conditional. Perhaps, the most likely scenario is a nominal growth rate of 14% per annum over the next 10 years, which will take Tamil Nadu towards becoming a \$1.5 trillion economy by 2038-39. We can always strive for something better.

stakeholders and states with an interest in the safe and efficient use of the Straits. These contributions do not amount to tolls. The fund is administered on a rotation basis by a committee comprising representatives of the three littoral States and the contributors. The three littoral States – Indonesia, Malaysia and Singapore – do not impose fees, tolls or any other form of payment on ships exercising their right of transit passage.

The geographic parallel

The Strait of Hormuz is similar to the Malacca-Singapore Straits, in that the territorial waters of Iran and Oman intersect, making sections of the Strait part of their territorial waters.

In 1993, Iran, which has not ratified UNCLOS, passed a law requiring foreign warships to seek its authorisation to pass through the Strait. This continues to be a sore point today.

Persian Gulf nations have a history of both conflict and cooperation. The United Arab Emirates, for instance, was among Iran's leading trading partners. Qatar is among the Persian Gulf nations that have supported the Iran-Oman talks. It had also mooted the Malacca-Singapore straits as a model.

Yet, even if the Gulf nations arrive at a framework they all agree on, the U.S. has shown that it may not accept it. The Malacca-Singapore issue was resolved as UNCLOS itself was being put into effect, when trade-offs were part of negotiating a convention intended to govern the world's oceans.

A key concern in the Malacca-Singapore Straits was the safety of navigation and the environment, whereas in the Strait of Hormuz, the key issue is Iran's security.

Iran is demanding that all nations revisit the Strait of Hormuz, and some are willing to do so. Though Iran and Oman have apparently agreed on a framework for reopening the Strait of Hormuz, the Strait has not been reopened, and the U.S. has not accepted the arrangement. The context has changed, even though there are clear parallels in the technical details.

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LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

A tussle that distresses

The challenge to the reappointment of N. Chandrasekaran as Chairman of Tata Sons on September 17 is distressing to the company's stakeholders in particular and to thousands of shareholders in the Indian corporate world in general (Page 1, “Tata Sons Board did not meet conditions: Trusts”, September 21). The reputation and esteem meticulously built over

many decades by the Tata brand in the business world are at great risk of erosion because of the impatient and intolerant attitude of the Board of Directors. A quarrel in public is no way to resolve differences among learned, experienced and wise board members. India, known for a paucity of eminent leaders in politics, eagerly looks to the corporate world for wise and pragmatic business leaders who can

provide good governance. Individual egos need to be set aside.

M.V. Nagavender Rao,
Hyderabad

Politics and decorum

Even the staunchest critics of Prime Minister Narendra Modi would find it difficult to accept Rahul Gandhi, the Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, turning an event meant to address the serious issues confronting today's youth into a vehicle

to lampoon the Prime Minister. Using a stand-up comedian to mimic and ridicule Mr. Modi at such an event was unbecoming of the office of the Leader of the Opposition. By encouraging such mimicry, Mr. Gandhi has betrayed a lack of political maturity. A person portrayed by Gandhi family loyalists as a potential Prime Minister is expected to conduct himself with dignity and poise. The Bharatiya Janata Party's

outrage is not misplaced. S.K. Choudhury,
Bengaluru

The developments remind me of the days when Jawaharlal Nehru was Prime Minister. The celebrated cartoonist K. Shankar often drew cartoons criticising and poking fun at Nehru. Far from taking offence, Nehru reportedly encouraged Shankar to continue criticising him through his

cartoons. Whether one agrees with the criticism or not, this reflects an important democratic principle: those in power must be able to tolerate criticism, satire and even ridicule. Freedom of expression is one of the very foundations of a democratic society.

Mohan Nedungadi,
Cherppulassery, Keralam

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The Koran and politics of purdah

Recently, Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar of the Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama issued a circular directing public halls and madrasas not to permit women to share public spaces with unrelated men during religious events.

He subsequently sought to justify the restriction with the startling claim that bringing women onto public platforms would cause “great destruction.” He attributed this danger to the mixing of men and women and said that the Koran itself requires women to remain confined to their homes, and prohibits them from appearing in public.

But the Koran does not instruct women to remain confined to their homes. It is conservative clerics who have historically sought to impose such restrictions by taking out of context the instruction in verse 33:33 to “stay in your houses” and “do not display yourselves as was the display of the former times of ignorance.”

Yet the verse occurs within a passage beginning at verse 28 that is explicitly addressed to the Prophet’s wives wherein the Prophet is instructed to give them a choice: they may seek the comforts and adornments of worldly life, in which case they will be granted a gracious separation, or they may choose Allah, the Prophet and the hereafter, for which they will receive a great reward. Their position is then distinguished from that of other women before laying down a heightened standard of conduct for them. They are told to avoid overly soft speech with men, to remain in their houses, not to display themselves as women did in the



A. Faizur Rahman

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The historical record does not support the idea that Islam required women to be confined to their homes or excluded from public life

pre-Islamic period, and to follow Allah and the Prophet. The passage culminates in a reference intended to keep the Prophet’s household spiritually pure.

Not about all women

As is clear, the command to “remain in your houses” is addressed only to the Prophet’s wives. To remove this instruction from its specific context and present it as a universal Koranic command requiring all Muslim women to remain at home is to extend the verse beyond the scope stated in the passage itself.

Moreover, the historical record does not support the idea that Islam required women to be confined to their homes or excluded from public life. Hazrat Khadija, the Prophet’s first wife, was a successful merchant who conducted her own commercial affairs, and the Prophet himself worked for her as a trading agent before their marriage. Even after he became the Prophet, there is no indication that he asked Khadija to abandon her public life. Obviously, the Prophet did not regard a woman’s participation in economic and social life as incompatible with Islam.

The same is true of the Prophet’s wives who lived after the revelation of Koran 33:33. Hazrat Aisha travelled with the Prophet, including on military expeditions and for the Hajj, and later became one of the most important authorities on religion in the early Muslim community. She also played a public role in the political conflict that culminated in the Battle of the Camel in 656 CE. Hazrat Umm Salama, another wife of the Prophet, was likewise consulted on public matters.

These examples make it difficult to interpret “remain in your houses” in 33:33 as a command of absolute physical confinement. Whatever restrictions it imposed on the Prophet’s wives, the historical record provides little basis for turning it into a universal prohibition against women participating in public life or sharing public spaces with men. Not surprisingly, in *Al-Muhaddithat*, the English introduction to his 43-volume Arabic compendium of Muslim women scholars, Mohammad Akram Nadwi rejects the view that Islam is “a human construct, done mainly by men and therefore done to secure advantages for them at the expense of women.”

Nonetheless, the subjugation of women cannot be challenged through reformist rhetoric alone. It requires the Muslim laity to publicly question clerical authority itself, and political leaders to stop lending legitimacy to regressive clerical institutions through high-profile visits and public engagement. The recent meeting of Malaysian PM Anwar Ibrahim with Mr. Aboobacker in Keralam illustrates the problem. Such public recognition can embolden male clerics to present patriarchal interpretations as divine commands and discourage Muslims from questioning them. The future of Islam cannot be left to those who claim a monopoly over its interpretation. If Muslims are to progress, the Koran must remain the primary point of reference, while the Prophet’s life must be taken seriously as evidence of how Koranic principles were actually lived.

Persistent antagonism towards Urdu

In June 2026, a group of approximately 10-15 men entered Bharat Chandra High School in Armoor, Nizamabad district, Telangana, and allegedly manhandled its 37-year-old Principal, Aamir Khan. The incident reportedly arose from the perception that Urdu was being taught at the school. However, Mr. Khan, an English teacher, was not responsible for teaching Urdu; the subject had been taught briefly by another teacher. The school’s management board, headed by a person of Hindu background, had decided to introduce Urdu as a second language following a request from the parents of Muslim students, who constitute approximately 25% of the school’s total strength.

This episode is particularly significant in light of a Supreme Court judgment in April 2025, which described Urdu as a fine expression of *Ganga-Jamuni Tehzeeb*. A Bench comprising Justices Sudhanshu Dhulia and Vinod Chandran observed that “language belongs to a community, to a region, to people but not a religion.” The Court upheld the use of Urdu on the signboard of a municipal council in Maharashtra and declined to interfere with the Bombay High Court’s ruling, which had found no legal prohibition under the Maharashtra Local Authorities (Official Languages) Act, 2022, against the use of Urdu.

The contrast between the constitutional-legal recognition of Urdu as a linguistic and cultural tradition and the hostility towards it highlights the contested and communal



Shaikh Mujibur Rehman

Author of ‘Shikwa-e-Hind: The Political Future of Indian Muslims’. Views are personal

The antagonism towards Urdu is rooted in the perception that it is exclusively a language for Muslims

nature of the language in today’s India.

The antagonism towards Urdu is rooted in the perception that it is exclusively a language for Muslims. The establishment of Bangladesh in 1971 around the Bengali language demonstrated that Urdu is not the language of Muslims as a whole. Moreover, Urdu has historically been spoken and cultivated by Hindus, Sikhs, and others. Rakhshanda Jalil’s edited volume, *Whose Urdu Is It Anyway?*, brings together writings by several prominent non-Muslim literary figures, including Gulzar, Ramanand Sagar, Rajinder Singh Bedi, and Kishan Chander. Their contributions demonstrate how Urdu has historically been embedded within a diverse literary and cultural tradition. A particularly revealing case is that of Rahi Masoom Raza, the author associated with the TV serial *Mahabharat*. It has recently come to light that his novel *Aadha Gaon* (Half Village), a classic of modern Hindi literature, was originally written by him in Urdu.

Not all that different

In ordinary discourse, the difference between Hindi and Urdu is not easily noticeable. According to Paul Brass, Urdu, “in its original form, was nothing more grammatically than the spoken Hindustani of north India, particularly Khari Boli of the Delhi area, with an infusion of Persian, Arabic, and Turkish vocabulary.” This shared linguistic heritage highlights the extent to which Hindi and Urdu evolved from a common linguistic base. In 1837, Persian was replaced by English and other vernacular languages in various

provinces of British India for administrative and judicial purposes. In north India, however, the vernacular language selected for official use was not Hindi, but Urdu written in the Perso-Arabic script. This linguistic policy subsequently became a source of controversy and led to the emergence of the Hindi movement.

Around this period, two publications, one by Babu Shiva Prasad and another by Madan Mohan Malviya, contributed significantly to bolstering the Hindi movement. In 1868, Babu Shiva Prasad published a memorandum on court characters, in which he highlighted the adverse effects of the use of Urdu in the North-Western Provinces and Oudh (administrative province in British India). Similarly, Madan Mohan Malviya’s *Court Character and Primary Education in the North-Western Provinces and Oudh* expressed concern over the detrimental impact of officially encouraging Urdu among a Hindu population. At the same time, pro-Urdu campaigns also emerged. Thus, the controversy increasingly moved beyond pamphlets and petitions, giving rise to various organised efforts.

In independent India, the Hindi-Urdu controversy continued to be a divisive political issue, particularly in north India. The persistence of antagonism towards Urdu is especially striking in a country where English, a language of foreign origin, continues to be widely valued and institutionalised across regions. In contrast, Urdu, despite its historical and cultural roots in the Indian subcontinent, continues to encounter hostility.

Decoding the transition to alternative fuels

While adoption of EVs has risen in the passenger vehicles category, it is mainly two-wheeler and three-wheeler categories that are adopting EVs than cars

DATA POINT

Sachin Swaraj
Gandla Sneha

August 2026 marked a notable milestone in India’s journey towards a shift from fossil-fuel run vehicles to Electric Vehicles (EVs), as the data from the Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations’ (FADA) showed that it was a period of a “historic fuel crossover”.

In the passenger vehicles category that mainly includes cars, FADA data showed that, for the first time, the share of new vehicles in the alternative fuels category (41.95%) overtook the share of petrol vehicles (40.85%). FADA’s statement said that alternative fuels included “CNG, hybrid and electric combined”.

Without doubt, India has made considerable progress in moving away from fossil fuels and adapting EVs. As **Chart 1** shows, petrol and diesel still dominate the market by a huge margin, accounting for 83.5% of all the roughly 82 lakh vehicles registered from January to March this year. But this is a sharp 11.5 percentage points drop from the same period in 2021, when petrol and diesel accounted for over 95% of all the 57 lakh vehicles registered then.

Less adoption among cars

While the chart shows the sale of EVs on a sharp increase, accounting for 10.6% of total registrations, a granular analysis of sub-categories under the alternative fuels based on data accessed from the Vahan portal showed that this was driven more by EV adoption in the two-wheeler and three-wheeler categories. When it came to cars, the growth under the alternative fuels is more pronounced in vehicles that use CNG and LPG, which are fossil fuels with significantly lower emissions, than EVs.

The two-wheeler segment which accounts for over 70% of all

the new vehicles registered in the country had shown signs that EV adoption is gaining pace.

After registering a marginal increase year-on-year, the share of EVs in two-wheelers has made a jump from 6.4% in 2025 to 9.1% in 2026 (till August) (**Chart 2**). This is also the first time the share of two-wheelers running on petrol has come down to the 90% mark. This jump in the sale of EV two-wheelers has contributed significantly to the overall share of petrol and diesel vehicles, across all categories, coming down well below the 85% mark this year.

If there is one segment that has made a rapid transition away from petrol and diesel, it is the three-wheeler category. They, however, account for only 4% of all the vehicles sold. Of the roughly 9.8 lakh three-wheelers registered till August this year, 60.5% have been EVs (**Chart 3**). The share of petrol and diesel in the registration of three-wheelers has halved from nearly 30% in 2021 to less than 15% in 2026. Interestingly, the share of three-wheelers using CNG or LPG has also come down this year.

It is in the cars segment, which accounts for the second biggest share in vehicles after two-wheelers, that the picture is more nuanced than what the shift indicates when “alternative fuels” are clubbed together. **Chart 4** shows a remarkable drop in the share of petrol and diesel cars from 86% in 2021 to 61.6% in 2026.

However, this decline is because there are more hybrid cars that run on petrol with CNG or LNG than EVs. There is certainly progress in the sale of EVs, but it is much slower when compared to vehicles using CNG or LPG. The share of hybrid EVs has remained fairly constant since 2023 at around eight per cent. The data indicates the need for further interventions through measures such as the ramping up of charging infrastructure, which can help accelerate the pace of EV adoption among cars as well.

Nuance in the mix

The data for the charts were sourced from the Vahan portal. Values for 2026 are till August. Vehicles in few other fuel categories with negligible share in total registrations are not shown in the charts. Sachin Swaraj and Gandla Sneha are interning with The Hindu’s Data team



CHART 1: The lines show the total number of vehicles registered in each fuel category while the values within brackets show the share of each fuel type in total vehicles registered. Q1 - Jan to March, Q2 - Apr to June, Q3 - July to Sep, Q4 - Oct to Nov

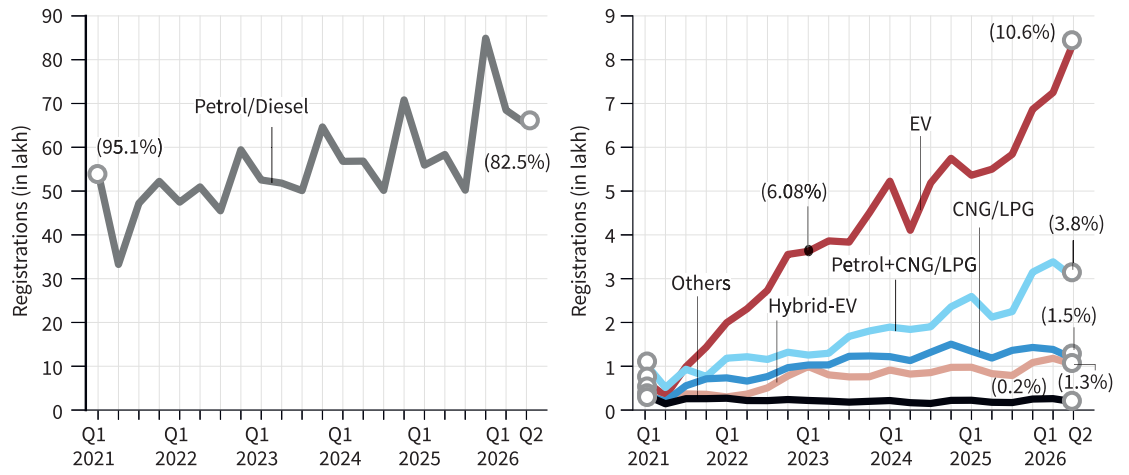
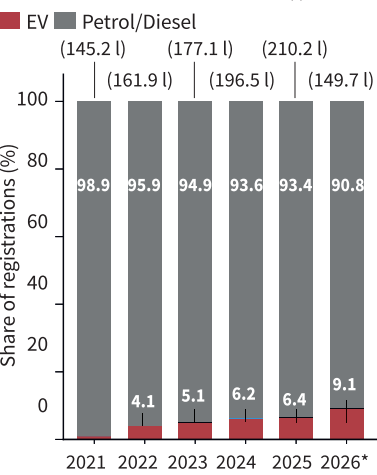
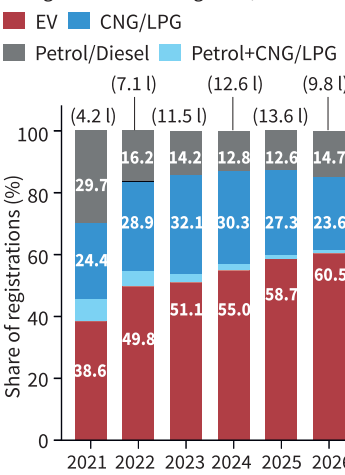


CHART 2: Share of EVs in two-wheelers has shown a notable jump in 2026. Values above bars in Charts 2, 3 and 4 show number of vehicles in lakh (l)



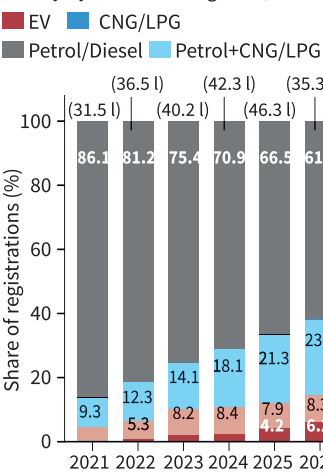
For the first time, the sale of petrol vehicles in the number of new two-wheelers registered has dropped to 90% mark in 2026

CHART 3: EVs now dominate three-wheelers, while share of vehicles using petrol/diesel have come down sharply along with those using CNG / LPG



The share of EVs among three-wheelers has jumped from less than 40% in 2021 to over 60% in 2026

CHART 4: While share of petrol and diesel vehicles in sale of cars has come down, their share is replaced mostly by vehicles using CNG / LPG



The share of petrol/diesel vehicles has come down significantly, but share of EVs is growing only marginally

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 22, 1976

Chavan asks passport officers to be quick, alert

New Delhi, September 21: The External Affairs Minister, Mr. Y.B. Chavan, to-day set for the passport officers in the country the twin task of being efficient and quick in the disposal of passport applications while at the same time guarding against organised activities of spurious agents and touts.

Addressing the nine Regional Passport Officers in the country, Mr. Chavan said that these might “look rather contradictory, but they are infact, not.” What was demanded of them, he said, was “awareness, alertness and vigilance combined with efficiency and courtesy.”

This was all the more so because of the increasing number of people who sought passports. Perhaps passport offices were the only instrument through which the External Affairs Ministry came in constant touch with the public and thus the working of the Ministry would be judged by the public by the way they functioned.

Unlike in the past, all categories of people, skilled and unskilled went abroad, particularly because of India’s economic co-operation with several developing countries. It should be remembered that there were certain organised agencies to commit economic offences. Passport was an important instrument for such offences across the national boundaries and this activity, he said was “quite considerable”.

It was, therefore, important for the Passport Officers, to be vigilant while at the same time being courteous to those who approached them.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 22, 1926

Hooliganism in Russia

Riga, September 21: A message from Moscow says that hooliganism is so alarming all over Russia that it is unsafe to walk after dark in less frequented streets even in Moscow and Leningrad. All classes of people in town and country are demanding that the Government should take up the matter. Many assaults on girls and other acts of violence are reported. Workmen’s clubs are forming unofficial bodies of police for self-protection.

At a meeting convened to discuss the situation, the Commissar of Interior recommended that the worst offenders should be shot as was already being done in Ukraine.

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Ethiopian armed groups announcing anti-govt. alliance

7 Seven Ethiopian armed groups said they have formed an alliance aimed at overthrowing Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed's government. The announcement of the Ethiopian Peoples' Forces Alliance for Survival brought together diverse groups ranging from Tigray in the north to the Somali Region in the south. REUTERS

Number of vehicles fined for illegal parking in Keralam

32,385 The Traffic and Road Safety Management wing of Keralam Police has collected ₹1.08 crore in fines from 32,385 vehicles for traffic violations, mainly illegal parking, during a Statewide seven-day inspection, police said. PTI

Number of vacancies in J&K government departments

40,672 In reply to questions from MLAs Sajad Lone and Irfan Hafeez Lone about recruitment and vacancies, the government said there were 40,672 vacancies across various government departments. PTI

Predicted decline in Maharashtra's sugar production

20 in per cent. Sugar production in Maharashtra may fall by nearly 20% in the upcoming crushing season, according to the West India Sugar Mills Association (WISMA). It said Maharashtra has faced a severe rain shortfall this year that adversely affected various crop yields. PTI

Amount of fine on Google by the EU for data location breach

403 in € million. Ireland's data protection watchdog, acting on behalf of the European Union, said on Monday that it had fined Google €403 million (\$462 million) for improperly using users' location data. AFP
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Why did the SC reject methanol rules?

What did the Supreme Court find wrong with Maharashtra's methanol rules? Why did the court hold the methanol restrictions disproportionate? What constitutional rights did the impugned rules violate? What guidelines did the Supreme Court issue to prevent tragedies?

EXPLAINER

Rizmi Lia M.

The story so far:

On September 18, the Supreme Court struck down Maharashtra government rules requiring methanol to be denatured with a colourant and bitterant before sale to non-drug manufacturers, holding that the measures were disproportionate and lacked sufficient connection with the problem they sought to address. A Bench, including J.B. Pardiwala and K. Vinod Chandran, allowed the writ petitions filed by the methanol-based product manufacturers against the mandatory inclusion of additives in methanol because of amendments to the Maharashtra Poisons Rules, 1972.

What was the case about?

Methanol, or methyl alcohol, is a highly toxic substance. It is also widely used as an industrial raw material in products including formaldehyde, paraformaldehyde, paints, resins and other chemicals.

The Maharashtra government introduced stricter controls on methanol following a 1991 hooch tragedy in Mumbai, in which around 93 people died after consuming spurious liquor containing methanol. A committee headed by then Additional Director General of Police P.R. Parthasarthy was constituted to examine the causes of the tragedy and suggest measures.

In 2011, Maharashtra amended its Poisons Rules and introduced Rules 18A and 18B.

The petitioners are aggrieved by the operation of the impugned Rules 18A and 18B of the Maharashtra Poisons Rules, respectively, which restrict the purchase of methanol and mandate the addition of bitterant and colourant to methanol before sale to a non-drug manufacturer. Further, by operation of Rule 18B, any possession of methanol without a licence in Form A is liable to confiscation.

Companies told the court that colour contamination could make products



GETTY IMAGES

unacceptable to the paint and pharmaceutical industries, while the additives could affect catalysts, laboratory and pharmaceutical applications.

The State, however, argued that the rules were necessary because methanol could be mixed with liquor and cause fatal poisoning. Making methanol identifiable and bitter would help prevent its misuse, it added.

What did the court examine?

The central question was whether Rules 18A and 18B violated Articles 14 and 19(1)(g) of the Constitution.

The basic tenet of Article 14 is fairness in action and non-arbitrariness, while Article 19(1)(g) protects the right to carry on an occupation, trade or business. The court said that the State does have the power to regulate methanol. The Poisons Act, 1919 permits State governments to make rules regulating the possession and sale of poisons. But the question before the court was whether Rules 18A and 18B, respectively, of the Maharashtra Poisons Rules could be said to be arbitrary, disproportionate, and unreasonable.

What was the ruling?

The Supreme Court held that the impugned provisions of the Maharashtra Poisons Rules, 1972, were unconstitutional.

The court found that Rule 18A(1), which

required verification of a purchaser's Form A licence before methanol could be sold, imposed a disproportionate restriction on legitimate industrial users. The court held that merely verifying a Form A licence did not establish how the purchaser would use methanol.

The court also struck down Rule 18A(2), which required methanol sold to non-drug manufacturers to be mixed with a colourant and bitterant. It held that the requirement did not have a reasonable and proximate nexus with preventing the misuse of methanol in illicit liquor. The State failed to demonstrate that the additives would prevent diversion or manufacture of spurious liquor.

"What is discernable from the above is that in practicality, the impugned rules prescribe a regulatory framework that does not prevent the misuse of methanol in liquor which takes place in the unregulated field. The sub-rule even in the best case of full compliance cannot prevent the misuse it aims to prevent... It addresses a mischief, it does not in fact remedy while imposing a continuous burden on the industries," it observed.

As for Rule 18B, which provided for confiscation of methanol possessed without a Form A licence, the court found that it could conflict with the lawful possession of methanol under a Form B permit and effectively render that permit redundant. The provision, therefore, also

failed the proportionality test.

Applying the proportionality framework laid down in *K.S. Puttaswamy v. Union of India* (2017), the court held that although the prevention of loss of life from methanol-adulterated liquor constituted a legitimate aim, the impugned restrictions were neither suitable nor necessary to achieve that objective. The court consequently allowed the writ petitions, disposed of the connected civil appeal, and held that the impugned rules were violative of Articles 14 and 19(1)(g). The court noted that "a policy that is irrational, or lacks rational justification, or is violative of any constitutional, statutory or any other provision of law is liable to be struck down".

What were the guidelines?

The court passed the guidelines regarding important aspects and steps to prevent hooch tragedies and for effective implementation of the policies.

The court said States should work together through the prohibition, excise, police, transport, industries and health departments, along with NGOs, to prevent illegal liquor. This includes checking State borders, stopping illegal transport, identifying places where illicit liquor is made or stored, and monitoring industrial units that may illegally supply chemicals used to make spurious liquor.

As regards the existing rules in States/Union Territories, the court said methanol rules should be strengthened. Licences should be granted only after proper verification and should be regularly reviewed. Industrial users should return unused or excess methanol, maintain proper stock and consumption records, and face suspension or cancellation of licences for violations. Methanol should be transported in dedicated tankers under excise supervision and sealed in a way that prevents theft, diversion or tampering.

It also called for more de-addiction centres, support for affected families and local counselling centres.

The court added that while it could issue directions, effective implementation ultimately depends on the police and enforcement machinery.

THE GIST

▼ The Supreme Court struck down Maharashtra's rules requiring methanol sold to non-drug manufacturers to be denatured with colourant and bitterant, finding them disproportionate and unconstitutional under Articles 14 and 19(1)(g)

▼ It held that the rules did not have a reasonable and proximate nexus with preventing methanol misuse in illicit liquor, while imposing continuing burdens on legitimate industries

▼ The court issued guidelines for States to strengthen methanol regulation, including stricter licensing, stock and transport controls, and inter-departmental enforcement

How will Gaganyaan's crew module deploy its parachutes?

Why does Gaganyaan need multiple parachutes? How are they tested?

Unnikrishnan Nair S.

The story so far:

Any spacecraft entering the earth's atmosphere will rely primarily on atmospheric drag to lose a significant fraction of its velocity. To gently touch down on land or in the sea, additional decelerating systems like parachutes have to be activated.

The parachute used for crewed space vehicles demands extraordinary engineering with multi-staging, redundancy, high-performance materials and high-pressure packing to reduce storage space.

How are parachutes deployed?

The parachute system contains three types of chutes: pilot, drogue, and main. The pilot chute is a mini-parachute

deployed to pull out wider drogue or main chutes. The drogue chute is deployed early in the descent to stabilise the module and first reduce the velocity. The main chute has a wider canopy and is used in the final phase to reduce the velocity enough to achieve gentle soft-landing conditions.

The crew module's blunt shape creates a turbulent wake in its rear side and the parachute has to be ejected through this wake. The ejection mechanism should ensure the energy imparted to the parachute suffices to cross the wake in the shortest time and deploy the parachute in the far-wake region.

Generally, the parachutes are deployed when the module has reduced its speed to below the speed of sound.

Why deploy parachutes in stages?

As it descends, the Gaganyaan crew

module will be moving at around 170 m/s in the lower atmosphere. If the full-sized main parachute is deployed straightaway, it will experience a high opening shock, shredding the fabric or subjecting the crew to dangerously high deceleration.

Multi-staging, on the other hand, increases the chutes' diameter in successive stages, keeping the dynamic pressure to acceptable levels.

Also, to keep a chute from opening really quickly, a cord wound around the canopy restricts how far it can spread. After a preset delay, when the vehicle has slowed enough, a timed cutter severs the cord, which goes loose and allows the parachute to bloom fully.

How are parachutes tested?

There are different platforms to test parachutes. The 'rail track rocket sled' is a ground facility where a sled is accelerated

along rails by firing small solid motors, and the parachutes are deployed from the sled at an appropriate velocity. The Terminal Ballistic Research Lab, Chandigarh, has a state-of-the-art RTRS facility.

Other modes of testing include dropping the test article from a helicopter or an aircraft or using small rocket-powered test vehicles, which launch the crew module to some appropriate altitude and release it from there.

After splashdown in the sea or upon soft-landing on land, if the parachute is not detached immediately, the wind acting on the canopy could drag the module on land or capsize it in sea and this might cause injuries to the astronauts. Hence, the parachute is released by activating pyro cutters or mechanical quick-release devices.

What materials are used in aerospace parachutes?

A parachute's material is controlled by conditions like tensile strength, thermal resistance, and mass. Modern aerospace parachutes use advanced synthetic polymers engineered to meet specific design conditions.

Kevlar is used in high-load suspension lines, risers, and structural reinforcement tapes due to its exceptional tensile

strength and heat resistance. Nomex finds application in heat-exposed areas to withstand hot mortar gas discharge and aerothermal heating.

Nylon is widely used for canopy broadcloths because of its elasticity, which helps absorb initial dynamic shock loads during inflation. It is highly compressible, so it can be packed into a relatively small volume.

What parachutes are in the Gaganyaan crew module?

In crewed missions, recovery systems use redundant clusters of pilot, drogue, and main parachutes. The Gaganyaan crew module has two drogue chutes deployed by mortars and three main chutes deployed by mortar-ejected pilot chutes.

If one main parachute suffers an anomaly, the remaining two independent chains are fully capable of ensuring a safe touchdown.

ADRDE in Agra, which is a laboratory under the Defence Research & Development Organisation, is the developing agency.

(Unnikrishnan Nair S. is former director, VSSC and IIST; Founding Director, HSFC; and an expert in launch vehicle systems, orbital re-entry and human spaceflight technologies. Currently Dr Sarabhaj Professor at VSSC)

ABSTRACT

Parental demand, education markets and the spread of ideologies

Hindutva is spreading through everyday interactions in the education market, with parents playing a role in shaping school decisions; marketisation allows majoritarian preferences to be expressed as consumer demands, with schools accommodating them while sidelining minority concerns

Rebecca Rose Varghese

Arora-Kukreja Ritika, 'Hindutva by Other Means: The Educational Market and the Politics of Demand', Economic and Political Weekly, Vol 61 Issue No. 34, August 22, 2026

Recently, an advertisement for a jewellery brand featuring a Bollywood actress during Raksha Bandhan was taken down by the brand following public outrage over her attire, which some considered insufficiently modest for a traditional festival. While there were debates over whether her dressing should be judged in such a manner, the brand eventually took down the advertisement and apologised to a section of the public, responding to pressure from a majoritarian opinion.

In another incident, a Muslim IPS officer in Bengal was transferred after Hindutva groups criticised her for using an Islamic greeting on social media. While the government and its nationalist ideologies may have their own role in such incidents, public pressure in this case was an important factor that resulted in her immediate transfer.

In both these cases, the institution or management responded to the majoritarian or dominant public view.

When we think about how ideologies spread and become embedded in everyday life, we often assume that the state apparatus plays the primary role, using its institutions and various forms of authority to promote particular ideas. What we often overlook, however, is the influence of the majoritarian public itself.

Public pressure, consumer choices, social expectations and everyday interactions can also become important channels through which an ideology is reproduced and normalised.

One of the best locations to examine the spread of political and religious ideologies is schools, because history shows how the moulding of young minds can become a central aspect of ideological reproduction.

Studies have shown how state apparatuses have often been used to promote particular political and social ideologies through education. Hindutva is one such right-wing political ideology of Hindu nationalism that seeks to define India's cultural and national identity through Hindu values and heritage and influence public policy, which the state has promoted through schools in India. The Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)-led governments, both during the 1998-2004 period and from 2014 to date, have used the state's power over curriculum and regulation to advance a particular vision of Indian nationhood. This literature has produced a robust analytical vocabulary to think of saffronisation as a product of a state-led project: the deliberate use of state institutional capacity to reshape the content and culture around education in a way that resonates with the Hindu majoritarian conception of the nation.

But is this the only way Hindutva enters schools? Are there no other players?

While the state may have a direct role in shaping government schools, what about spaces where its hold is less direct, particularly private urban schools that often present themselves as modern, cosmopolitan and removed from such



Growing influence: In the education market, parents express their preferences, which school management responds to and incorporates into its decisions. THULASI KAKKAT

ideological concerns?

Think of the first two examples in the context of such schools. This is what author Ritika Arora-Kukreja does in her article.

The article is particularly relevant as it examines other factors that have helped push Hindutva ideology into schools. The paper argues that Hindutva is increasingly spreading through everyday interactions in the education market, not just through government policies or Hindutva organisations. This side of education has largely been overlooked by both the literature on marketisation and the literature on saffronisation.

Through in-depth interviews and focus group methods with households with children, and interviews with school leaders across private schools in Delhi-NCR between April and September 2022, the author analyses the increasing role of parents as actors pushing for Hindutva ideologies to spread in Indian schools.

From regulation to market demand

The Nehruvian model of education after independence was such that the state provided, regulated and directly controlled institutions. But after the 1991 liberalisation reforms, the relationship between the state and institutions, especially schools, changed drastically. With privatisation, the middle and upper-middle classes, especially in urban India, started attending private schools, where state control was extremely limited. The author explains that in Delhi, where she did her study, private-school enrollment at the primary and middle levels increased from around 30% in 2014-15 to over 46% in 2019-20. So while the state did not disappear and still continued to spread ideologies through

the curriculum and syllabus, its role in directly influencing and promoting ideologies had its limits.

The state was then replaced by market demands, especially those of the dominant middle and upper-middle classes. Parental preferences started taking precedence over the state apparatus and shaped decisions made by school management.

For instance, if parents do not approve of the appointment of a Muslim teacher due to the fear that they may promote Islam, they are not admitted. Or if the majority of parents are vegetarian, the school may make a rule that non-vegetarian food should not be brought for lunch, which inevitably affects children from other religions and cultures. Schools succumb to the demands of the dominant group while sidelining minorities, fearing the repercussions of not doing so.

The Hindu customer

Strong competition between schools, combined with the majoritarian population in a region, creates what the author calls the "Hindu customer", whose demands have to be met by school management. Highlighting Hindu festivals in schools, giving holidays for them, deliberately not admitting students from certain religious groups, and attempting to ban the hijab from schools are some examples. The author calls this "hyper-accountability".

While marketisation is supposed to make schools more accountable by giving parents more power and making schools depend on parent satisfaction, in this context, schools are focused on satisfying the majority. The concerns of minority families are ignored, as their dissatisfaction will have a smaller

economic impact on schools.

Here, it is the Hindu customer who is being satisfied. Instead of being seen just as a religious identity, they attain the identity of a powerful customer in the education market, whose demands cannot be ignored.

Their economic power, combined with the growing political legitimacy of Hindu nationalism, ensures that schools meet their demands while trying to present them as reasonable. For instance, instead of citing religious reasons, schools use hygiene to justify banning non-vegetarian food and security to justify banning the hijab, while the same concerns are not applied to visual symbols of other religious groups.

Political demands as choices

One of the ways in which such demands are justified and seen as rational or reasonable is through what the author calls the "depoliticisation of choices". The demands or preferences of parents are seen as individual, private consumer choices rather than politically coloured ones. Marketisation literature often presents this in simple terms: the parent has a demand, and the market responds to it.

It therefore becomes important to understand how these preferences are formed. The author explains how citizens are influenced on a daily basis by ideas of Hindu nationalism through news media, social media, neighbourhoods and other forms of political socialisation. Their choices about education therefore also reflect these political and cultural ideas.

The market does not necessarily create these preferences. Instead, it provides a system where such preferences can be expressed as legitimate consumer demands and accommodated by schools that depend on satisfying their consumers. The author explains that the education market does not only reproduce class inequalities. In contemporary India, it can also provide an institutional space for religious-nationalist preferences to enter and shape education.

Challenging the ideology spread

Challenging the spread of Hindutva or other religious ideologies in schools is important because education shapes young and impressionable minds and can influence how they understand religion and society. To do so, it is necessary to understand how such ideologies enter educational spaces.

Existing saffronisation literature has mainly focused on the role of the state and political organisations. The author draws attention to another channel, which she calls "bottom-up Hindutva". Unlike state-led Hindutva, which spreads from state institutions and political organisations into society, "bottom-up Hindutva" describes a process in which preferences and demands from society shape institutions. In the education market, parents express their preferences, which school management responds to and incorporates into their decisions. The paper is therefore important because it highlights other ways in which religious ideologies can spread, which need to be closely examined to understand and challenge their influence in education. (Rebecca Rose Varghese is a freelance journalist)



FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

What is the meaning of the expression "to go bananas"?

(R. Pillai, Chennai) This expression has several different meanings. When someone goes bananas about/over something, he/she becomes very enthusiastic about it. The expression is considered slang and is generally used in informal contexts. Here are a few examples.

The students went bananas when they heard that Mani was going to address them.

We all went bananas when we saw Steffi Graf walk into the gym.

To go bananas can also mean to drive someone crazy or mad. For example,

The constant questions made him go bananas.

When used in this sense, "to go bananas" means the same thing as "to go nuts" and "to go crazy". "Cool bananas" is an expression that is frequently used in American English as an exclamation. It is often used to mean "wow".

Satish got an A in the exam. Cool bananas!

What is the correct pronunciation of the word "harass"?

(B. Devarajan, Hubli)

The manner in which you pronounce this word will, to a large extent, depend on which side of the Atlantic you are from. For example, if you are from England, then you would tend to pronounce the first "a" like the "a" in "cat", "bat" and "act". The second would be pronounced like the "a" in "China," and the main stress would be on the first syllable. If, on the other hand, you come from the U.S., then you would do the exact opposite. You would pronounce the first "a" like the "a" in "China" and the second "a" like the "a" in "cat". The stress in this case would be on the second syllable.

What is the meaning and origin of the expression "trailblazer"?

(P. Anuradha, Hyderabad)

A trailblazer is someone who is the first to do something. For example, he or she could be someone who has discovered or developed a new method of doing something. Here are a few examples.

Jambu will always be remembered as a trailblazer in cancer research.

Padma was a trailblazer in the field of AIDS research.

One can even talk about an individual or an institution of having "blazed a trail". When someone blazes a trail, what you are implying is that he/she has done something that no one has done before; something that will benefit a lot of other people.

The company has blazed a trail in developing new medicines for curing AIDS.

The word "blaze" is generally associated with "fire". So "trailblazer" should be someone who develops something new by destroying everything that is old. This, however, is not the origin of the expression. The expression came into being in the late 18th Century when the American settlers were pushing further and further west – towards Oregon, California, etc. Since they were exploring uncharted territory and didn't want to get lost along the way, they used to mark the trail that they had taken.

One of the ways that they used to indicate the route they had taken was to remove the bark from some of the trees. This method of marking trees was known as "blazing". And since they were marking a trail, we get the expressions "blazing a trail" and "trailblazer". Published in The Hindu on January 8, 2002

THE DAILY QUIZ

September 22 marks the 40th anniversary of the second tied Test match in the history of cricket. How much do you remember about this historic India-Australia Test?

Soorya Prakash N.

QUESTION 1

Who is the only person connected with both the first and second tied Test matches?

QUESTION 2

Who were declared as players in the match from the respective sides?

QUESTION 3

While Greg Matthews took five in both innings, which other Australian bowler took the remaining five Indian wickets in their second innings?

QUESTION 4

Who became the first player to make 100 consecutive Test appearances during this historic Test?

QUESTION 5

Who deputised for regular Wicketkeeper Kiran More after he left the field on the first day due to food poisoning?

QUESTION 6

Who was the Wicketkeeper of Australia in that Test?

QUESTION 7

Which Indian allrounder remained unbeaten with a gritty 48 after ensuring that India would not lose that Test match?



Visual Question:

Identify the Umpire who declared the last man, Maninder Singh, out LBW? THE HINDU ARCHIVES

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. A man with a realistic dog's head and one leg in a cast wanders through New York City with a boombox. Ans: Daft Punk - Da Funk 2. A gymnast, played by Sofia Coppola, walks into a packed school sports hall to face a favoured rival. Ans: The Chemical Brothers - Elektrobank 3. A Frenchman wakes up, gets ready, and arrives in his customized car to compete in a car-audio decibel contest. Ans: DJ Mehdi - Signature 4. A kid on a metro discovers that the music player in his hand can pause, rewind and fast-forward the real world. A classic! Ans: Bomfunk MC's - Freestyler 5. Shot in black and white, two men walk towards the camera as their t-shirts come alive with colourful typography. Ans: Justice - D.A.N.C.E. 6. A group of children with telekinetic powers escape a facility, test their abilities and wait to join the outside world. Ans: M83 - Midnight City Visual: Identify the music video from the screengrab shown. It won the Film Craft Grand Prix in 2017. Ans: The Blaze - Territory Early Birds: Tamal Biswas | Piyali Tuli | Sukdev Shet | Tito Shiladitya | Prem Raj P.

Iconic Changemaker. Araku Valley Coffee received the Financial Transformation award, and Bhashini won for Digital Transformation. Impulse NGO Network took home the Social Transformation honour. The Young Changemaker award was shared by Kalyani Shinde and the Young Tinker Foundation.

The awards for 2025 were given away by Hardeep Singh Puri, Union Minister of Petroleum and Natural Gas.

Scan the QR code to watch the award ceremony live on YouTube.

India to attend session on UN-based multilateralism

EU, Brazil, Kenya, Canada launch grouping beyond 'superpower politics'; the P4M initiative seeks a more representative UN that is prepared for global challenges, including AI and climate change

Suhasini Haidar
NEW DELHI

India will join a number of countries committed to supporting United Nations (UN)-based multilateralism, away from “Superpower” politics, as External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar was set to attend the “Partners for Multilateralism” (P4M) meeting at the United Nations.

Mr. Jaishankar landed in New York on Monday at the start of the UN General Assembly’s “High-Level debate” session. He is due to hold a number of bilateral meetings and multilateral meetings there, and will address the UNGA on September 26.

The P4M initiative, founded by leaders of the European Union, Brazil, Kenya and Canada is expected to make a pitch for the grouping this week.

In a joint editorial, leaders of the four founders said the grouping will support the UN but push for it to be more representative and prepared for global challenges, including AI (artificial intelligence), climate change, health security and digital transformation.

“P4M will support the reform of the UN and other multilateral institutions, to make them more representative, legitimate, effective and trusted,” the leaders, including European Council President Antonio Costa, Brazil President Lula da



Gearing up: Security guards checking IDs of people ahead of the United Nations General Assembly in New York. REUTERS

Silva, Kenyan President William Rutto and Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney wrote in an editorial published in the U.K.-based *Financial Times*.

Mr. Carney had delivered a speech on “Middle powers” coming together at the World Economic Forum in Davos in January, which signalled growing dissatisfaction not just with Russia and China for unilateral moves and conflicts, but with the United States over trade and tariffs, expansionist moves, and the conflict in Iran that have been undertaken during U.S. President Donald Trump’s second term.

It is unclear whether India was asked to join the joint message.

India is already part of a number of groups like the Non-Aligned Movement,

India is already part of a number of groups like BRICS and G20 that have similar objectives

BRICS, G20, and G-4 that have similar objectives.

The editorial on Monday pointed to comments by United Nations Secretary-General António Guterres in which he had said that “superpowers are discovering their limits”, adding that the P4M grouping believes that the “international community must rediscover the extraordinary potential of collective action”.

Mr. Guterres, who demits office later this year, spoke to *The Hindu* amongst five global outlets in U.S., U.K., South Africa,

the Gulf region and India.

“We have superpowers that have not yet recognised that their power has limits and they get into adventures that produce terrible results,” Mr. Guterres had said, specifically pointing to Russia, which was still embroiled in the war in Ukraine four years later, while the U.S. is facing “difficulties” with its war in Iran.

‘Limits to powers’

“I think it’s time for superpowers to understand the limits of their power, and that will help the world become more peaceful,” Mr. Guterres said, speaking to *The Hindu* in New Delhi, where he attended the 18th BRICS Summit.

The editorial also said that the ‘Partners for Multilateralism’, would not create another exclusive bloc or international bureaucracy.

“Its purpose is the opposite: to create a flexible, open framework for countries from different regions and political traditions that are willing to work across divides, to build coalitions for reform and to translate shared principles into practical action,” the co-authors wrote, pointing out that 2025 saw the highest recorded number of state-based armed conflicts since 1946, in 35 countries, and highest recorded military spending of nearly \$3 trillion.

Will try to list Mamata’s plea against EC decision to freeze symbol of Trinamool: CJ

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday agreed to try and list a petition filed by former West Bengal Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee against a decision by the Election Commission to freeze the symbol of the Trinamool Congress.

Appearing before Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, who is leading a three-judge Bench, senior advocate Kapil Sibal, representing Ms. Banerjee, made an oral mentioning that the Election Commission’s interim order freezing the symbol, even as proceedings under the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order 1968, was unwarranted.

“The Election Commission is crossing new miles



Mamata Banerjee

tones every time,” Mr. Sibal submitted.

Chief Justice Kant said both sides would have arguments to make, and the court would hear all the parties. “We will try to hear it this week,” he said.

New allotment

The petition was filed hours after the poll body, on September 17, allotted new names and symbols to

the two factions of the Trinamool led by Mamata and Ritabrata Banerjee.

The Mamata faction got the name “Mamata All India Trinamool Congress” with “football player” as its symbol, while the Ritabrata grouping was allotted the name “Democratic Trinamool Congress” with the symbol “envelope”.

The plea said the EC did not comprehensively look into the party structure while considering rival claims made by the camps. The petition said the EC had banked on the statements of rebel legislators.

The Mamata camp has filed a petition highlighting the delay in the disqualification proceedings pending before the West Bengal Assembly Speaker against the 10 legislators from the rebel faction.

Congress nominee sent to judicial custody

The Hindu Bureau
KOLKATA

A West Bengal court on Monday remanded Milan Pradhan, Congress candidate for Nandigram byelection, in judicial custody for 14 days in connection with a case under the Arms Act registered in 2007.

Meanwhile, he applied for bail before the Calcutta High Court in separate cases dating back to 2007. He was arrested on September 18 in these cases and sent to judicial custody till October 3, hours after former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee extended her support to him.

The twin court orders have, for now, effectively ended his opportunity to canvass for himself as the campaign time for the by-poll, ends on October 4. (With PTI inputs)

Odisha final electoral roll has 3.16 crore voters, 17.66 lakh names struck off: CEO

Satvasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR

Odisha’s final electoral roll published on Monday has 3,16,32,754 voters, a decrease of 17,66,837 from the pre-special intensive revision (SIR) figure, according to the Office of the Chief Electoral Officer.

“The total number of voters after SIR process is 3,16,32,754 comprising 1,61,30,319 male,

1,54,99,661 female and 2,774 third gender voters,” Odisha CEO R.S. Gopalan said.

According to Mr. Gopalan, the total number of electors as on July 17 in the State was 3,33,99,591.

“A total of 3,13,87,034 enumeration forms, constituting 93.97% of the total, were received back from electors. The remaining 20,12,557 electors (6.03%) whose enumera-

tion forms were not received back were excluded from the draft electoral roll,” he said.

Those excluded from the draft roll included 8,32,544 who were found dead, 8,08,205 who had shifted out of their booths, 1,58,118 duplicate entries and 1,99,249 who were absent.

“During the claims and objections period from July 5, 2026 to August 19,

2026, a total of 2,55,996 claims and objections were received and processed for preparation of the final electoral roll. In addition, all forms received prior to July 5 were also processed for final publication. A total of 24,070 electors found ineligible for final electoral roll after hearing and 20,707 electors were deleted against the Form 7 received,” according to the CEO office.

Ansari’s remarks exposed Cong.: BJP

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Bharatiya Janata Party on Monday claimed that former Vice-President Hamid Ansari “exposed” the “Muslim League-Maoist character” of the Congress through his remarks about former Prime Minister Jawaharlal Nehru’s views on “Hindu right-wing communalism”.

At an event commemorating late constitutional expert A.G. Noorani on Saturday, Mr. Ansari had referred to Nehru’s view saying that “the real danger to India was not communism, but Hindu right-wing communalism”, citing Noorani’s book *The RSS: A Menace to India*.

Addressing a press conference, BJP MP and national spokesperson Sudhanshu Trivedi said the former Vice-President quoted the book, according to which Mr. Nehru said that for him communism was not as great a threat as Hindu nationalism.

‘Nehru reference’

“For this, I would like to congratulate Hamid Ansari that he has done three extremely important things. Number one, he has thoroughly exposed that the Congress has now completely become a Maoist Muslim League Congress. Secondly, he deserves congratulations for quoting that, according to Nehruji considered communism a threat. For the third point, who brought up the reference to Nehru?” he said. “It is a black chapter in the history of Independent India that five Ministers in the Kerala[m] government are from the Muslim League,” he said.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
MARKETING DEPARTMENT e-PROCUREMENT TENDER NOTICE
e-Tenders are invited for supply of (1) 81,00,000 Kgs of Sugar (S-30) (2) 1,80,000 Kgs of Goduma Ravva (3) 90,000 Kgs of Cardamom (Elachi) 8 mm (CGEB) variety through e-tenders to the Marketing Department, T.T.Devasthanams, For Tender notice and tender details log on to the web site <http://www.tirumala.org> and <https://tender.aeprocurement.gov.in>. For further details contact phone numbers: 0877-2264079, 2264555, FAX No: 0877-2264554.
TID-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Aad.No.187) Date:21-09-2026
EXECUTIVE OFFICER

Dr. NTR UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES :: A.P. :: VIJAYAWADA-8
NOTIFICATION FOR MDS ADMISSIONS 2026-27
MANAGEMENT QUOTA
Application forms through Online are invited from NEET MDS-2026 qualified candidates for admissions into Post Graduate Dental Courses respectively for filling up of Management Quota [S1, S2(NRI) & S3 (Institutional Quota)] seats in Private Un-aided Non-Minority Dental Colleges affiliated to Dr. NTR UHS in the State of Andhra Pradesh for the academic year 2026-27.

Schedule (Without a Late fee)	07.00 PM on 21-09-2026 to 10.00 PM on 24-09-2026
Schedule (With a Late fee)	08.00 AM on 25-09-2026 to 10.00 PM on 25-09-2026

Visit University Website <https://dntr.uhsap.in> for detailed Notification/ Prospectus and Regulations
Date: 21.09.2026 (Endorsement No.5148/EA2/PG/2026) Sd/- REGISTRAR

BHARAT DYNAMICS LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise) MINISTRY OF DEFENCE
GACHIBOWLI, HYDERABAD-500032.
Ref:BDL/CC/OT/GT/02/2026-27 Dt: 22.09.2026
e-PROCUREMENT ABRIDGED TENDER NOTICE
Inviting Indigenous Competitive Bidding

Sl.No.	Tender ID	Description	Estimate Amount in Rs.
1	67803	Horticulture & Maintenance in plant & Township at BDL Bhanur	129.15 Lakhs

Please visit website <https://bdltenders.abcpocure.com>, select online tenders on dashboard for further details. Bids should be submitted online only. "Corrigendum if any shall be issued through our e-portal only and not in Newspapers".
"Bidders are Requested to apply for online Vendor Registration in BDL website <https://bdd-india.in/registration-contractors> prospects.
DEPUTY GENERAL MANAGER (Corp Comm)

ANDHRA PRADESH POWER COORDINATION COMMITTEE
VIDYUT SOUDHA :: VIJAYAWADA
TENDER NOTICE
APPCO on behalf of the APDISCOMs inviting bids in two stage-RFQ followed by RFP through Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal for selection of thermal power developers towards Procurement of 1,600 MW of Thermal Power-DBFOO basis through Tariff Based Competitive Bidding("TBCB") under Section 63 of the Electricity Act, 2003.
The Interested and eligible applicants may participate in the bidding process through the Bharat Electronic e-Tendering Portal. Date & availability of RFQ document in Bharat Electronic ETS Portal is 21.09.2026 @ 23:59:00 Hrs the last date for submission of application is 05.11.2026 @ 10:00 Hrs. For complete details and tender access visit: <https://www.bharat-electronictender.com>; Ph: 9490153141.
Sd/- Chief General Manager/APPCO Power Purchase & Legal
R.O.No.GMCC/APTRANSCO/151/26-27

PUNJAB STATE WAREHOUSING CORPORATION
SCO 74-75, BANK SQUARE, SECTOR-17B CHANDIGARH
PBX: 0172-5197847, 5197846
NOTICE INVITING TENDER
PSWC invites online tenders through GeM Portal for creation of 0.45 LMT godown capacities at 03 locations in the State of Punjab for guaranteed lease of 10 years on Build, Own and Operate/Lease basis for storage requirements of FCI under two bid system "Technical Bid" and "Financial Bid".
NIT (alongwith GeM Bid IDs) is available on Department's website i.e. <https://pswc.in>
PSWC reserves the right to scrap the tender at any stage without assigning any reason and PSWC will not be held liable for any costs and consequences incurred by the intending bidders.
Note: Any corrigendum(s)/Notification(s) to this Notice Inviting E-Tender shall be published Department's website & GeM Portal.
1004/12/2026-27/15400
Managing Director, PSWC

TOURISM CORPORATION OF GUJARAT LIMITED (TCGL)
(A Government of Gujarat undertaking)
Nigam Bhavan Sector 16, Block C First Floor,
Nr. GH 4½ Bus Stand, Gandhinagar – 382 016.
Website: <https://www.gujarattourism.com>
TENDER NOTICE
The tender is invited by Tourism Corporation of Gujarat Ltd. (TCGL), for the Selection of Agency for "DEVELOPMENT OF TOURIST FACILITIES KUDA BEACH AT BHAVNAGAR". Estimate Cost of the Project **Rs.8,47,45,052.58/- + GST**. The interested bidders/agencies may download the tender document form the website: www.tender.nprocure.com from **23/09/2026** on ward Last dates of submission on online: **14/10/2026** up to 06.00 pm. Tender may also be referred on www.gujarattourism.com.
Managing Director of TCGL reserves the right to reject or accept any or all tenders without assigning any reason thereof.
Managing Director

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - "e" PROCUREMENT NOTICE
WORKS DEPARTMENT
E-mail: ceroads.bbsr@gmail.com
Bid Identification No. CE-Roads-II-03/2026-27
1. The Chief Engineer (Roads-II), Odisha on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bids in double cover system through ONLINE MODE from eligible contractors for Road work as mentioned below:
2. Nature of work : Road work
3. No. of Work : 5 Nos.
4. Tender Paper cost : Rs.10,000.00
5. Class of Contractor : 'A' Class / Special Class / Super Class
6. Available of bid document in the website : From 10.00 A.M. of 30.09.2026 to 5.30 P.M. of 22.10.2026
7. Date of opening of Bid : Dt.23.10.2026 at 11.30 A.M.
8. The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website: <https://tenderodisha.gov.in>. Any addendum / corrigendum / cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website.
Chief Engineer (Roads-II), Odisha
OFFICE OF THE ENGINEER-IN-CHIEF (CIVIL-CUM-ROADS), ODISHA, NIRMAN SOUDHA, BHUBANESWAR
34001/837/2627 OIPR-34001/34179/1/26-27/0006

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
PT1-HE-SCH-POLICY-0003-2026/ 50842/HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated : 21.09.2026
Corrigendum-VI
NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR BERHAMPUR UNIVERSITY, GANJAM UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BERHAMPUR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.
RFP No. PM-USHA : 02/2026 Date: 02.07.2026

Sl. No.	RFP Cl.No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Modified vide Corrigendum V, dated 03.09.2026	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.7 & 8)	5	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 23/07/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 03/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 08/10/2026 till 4:00 PM) (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 24/07/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 29/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 09/10/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.
Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, RUSA/PM-USHA
11001/331/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/11/26-27/0059

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT,
BHUBANESWAR
No- HE-UE-COMM-0009-2020 50704 /HE, dtd. 21.09.2026
ADVERTISEMENT FOR APPOINTMENT OF VICE-CHANCELLOR OF SAMBALPUR UNIVERSITY (SAMBALPUR, ODISHA)
Applications are invited from eligible applicants below 66 years as of 08.01.2027 (i.e. born on or after 09.01.1961) for the position of **Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University**. The applicant should be a distinguished academican of proven academic and administrative excellence and a well-rounded personality with a minimum of 10 years of experience as Professor in a University system or 10 years of experience in an equivalent position in reputed research and / or academic organization.
The post carries a fixed pay of **Rs.2,10,000/-** (Rupees two lakhs and ten thousand) with Special Allowance of **Rs.11,250/-** per month and other usual allowances such as Dearness Allowance. Provision of pay protection is applicable for candidates belonging to Central or State Government Public University or Institution. The tenure of the Vice-Chancellor will be four years from the date he/ she assumes office or till he/she attains 70 years of age; whichever is earlier.
Instructions for Submission of Application for the Post of Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University
Applicants are advised to strictly adhere to the following guidelines while submitting their applications:
1. **Application Format and Submission Platforms**
+ Applications must be submitted **physically in the prescribed format (and digitally in HIMS website of which details shared below)** available for download at the Department's website www.dhe.odisha.gov.in and the websites of the concerned University.
+ Applicants are also required to fill out the required application digitally in the HIMS Portal available at : hims.odisha.gov.in/ **Application-for-post-of-VC**.
+ The completed physical application form must be scanned and sent via **e-mail in PDF format only to hedsec.od@od.gov.in** with the subject line : "Application for the post of Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University".
+ After the scanned copy is sent through email, applicants are required to send the hard copy of the application physically to the department at the following address with clear mention at the envelope - "Application for the post of Vice-Chancellor of Sambalpur University".
• **Address :**
Office of Commissioner Cum Secretary, Higher Education Department, LokSeva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001.
+ The e-mail submission must be accompanied by the physical submission through Speed Post (India Post) and digitally in the HIMS portal as stated above, failure of which will lead to rejection of the application.
2. **Submission Deadline**
• Both the **e-mailed application (PDF format)** and the **HIMS Module** must be submitted no later than **23:55 hours on 23.10.2026**.
• **Failure to complete both submissions** (HIMS Module and email) by the specified deadline shall result in **rejection of the application**.
3. **Submission of Hard Copy**
• In addition to the online submission, a **hard copy** of the same application (as e-mailed), **duly ink-signed** and accompanied by all supporting documents, must be sent by **SPEED POST (India Post) only and not through courier** to the undersigned. Any other mode of submission of application will be liable for rejection.
• The hard copy should reach the Department's office **on or before 30.10.2026**. However, any **hard copy of the applications received after 30.10.2026** will be **rejected**, even if the same is posted before the deadline through email and HIMS Module.
4. **Other Conditions**
• In case **multiple applications** are submitted by a candidate, only the **last valid submission** digitally submitted on HIMS portal (as per time / stamp of the HIMS Module) will be considered. All previous submissions shall be rejected.
• **Late applications** received after the aforementioned deadlines via email, HIMS Module, or Indian Post **will not be considered** under any circumstances.
5. **Interview Process**
• Shortlisted candidates will be called for an interview before a **three-member Selection Committee**. The venue and schedule will be communicated in due course.
Commissioner-cum-Secretary to Government
Higher Education Department
Lok Seva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg
Bhubaneswar-751001. Phone:-(0674) 2536862
11001/330/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/11/26-27/0058

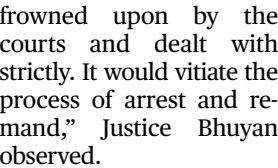
Namibian cheetah Gaurav died in Madhya Pradesh's Kuno National Park on Monday evening while undergoing treatment, an official said. Ten-year-old Gaurav was rescued from the wild on September 12 after he was observed to be weak and dull. The director said based on the preliminary clinical examination, an underlying chronic condition was suspected. "Despite continued treatment and supportive care, his condition deteriorated, and he died at around 4 p.m. on Monday," he said, adding that the exact cause of the death will be ascertained after post-mortem examination. Kuno National Park now has 51 cheetahs, the director said.

The Supreme Court on Monday sought a response from the States of Maharashtra and Haryana on a plea by stand-up comedian Pranit More to club FIRs registered against him in connection with the ‘₹370 biryani’ controversy. A three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant also issued notice to the Union government. The Maharashtra Cyber Police had registered an FIR against Mr. More, the member of the audience, Himanshu Jangra, and another person under various provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita. A separate petition had been filed by an advocate over Mr. More’s show which had been held in Gurugram.

Six persons have been arrested for molesting a woman doctor and assaulting her husband and other friends in a movie hall at Kolkata's Acropolis Mall on Sunday night. According to police, the couple went to watch a movie with their friends in the mall. Six men started intimidating her by making obscene gestures and derogatory comments. When her husband and friends protested, the accused assaulted them. A case under Sections 115(2) (voluntarily causing hurt), 79 (outraging woman's modesty), 126 (wrongful restraint) under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita have been booked against them.

Union Road Transport Minister Nitin Gadkari said on Monday the government will soon notify a policy rewarding safe driving with lower insurance premiums and penalising rash driving and traffic violations. "Good drivers should pay less for insurance; reckless drivers and rule-breakers should face penalties," he said. He said this would promote better road manners. The Minister had earlier said the government was planning a system to make drivers more accountable. Under the proposal, every traffic offence would lead to points being cut from a person's driving licence and vehicle registration. If too many points pile up, the licence or registration certificate could be suspended.

“Any breach or non-compliance would entail immediate release of the arrested person because such arrest is unconstitutional. We cannot tinker with the most important safeguards provided under Article 22... Any attempt to encroach upon the fundamental rights guaranteed under Article 22(1) of the Constitution has to be



The Bench, also comprising Justice Atul S. Chandurkar, said the right under Article 22(1) was a “mandatory constitutional safeguard”. It applied across the spectrum, including offences under the Indian Penal Code and under special enactments, which include the laws on terrorism and money laundering.

Probe agencies cannot shrug off a breach of Article 22(1) as a “mere procedural lapse”, Justice Bhuyan observed. Agencies cannot

contend that a violation of the Article would not render custody illegal or entitle an accused to bail. The agencies had it completely wrong, the Bench said.

“When an accused is released for violation of his fundamental rights under Article 22(1), he is not enlarged on bail. He is released from illegal and unconstitutional detention,” Justice Bhuyan emphasised.

Even subsequent filing of chargesheet and order of cognisance would not validate such an arrest, Justice Bhuyan underscored.

No blanket immunity

The court was answering a question as to whether an

The Congress said on Monday that the impact of GST rate cuts on a range of commodities was being eroded by "galloping inflation", with prices of several consumer products returning to pre-cut levels within a year.

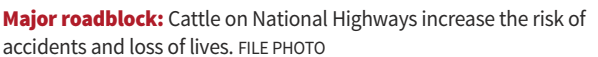
stance, automobile sales benefited while apparel sales did not," Mr. Ramesh said in a post on X.

“Now comes evidence that the effect of GST rate cuts on various commodities is being neutralised by ‘galloping inflation,’” he said.

The prices of several consumer goods had returned to nearly pre-GST cut levels within a year without any significant increase in consumption, he said. He also linked the issue to the broader state of the economy, questioning the narrative around India's growth based on GDP.

“Headline quarterly GDP numbers may give a momentary elation to the ruling establishment overlooking their imperfections, but there are many faultlines in the India growth story that are simply not being acknowledged by the PM and his brigade of cheerleaders,” he said.

The Centre has prescribed a one-metre high wall along the outer edge of high-speed corridors to prevent “unauthorised access and entry of stray cattle” in its first-ever guidelines that standardise design and development of such National Highways.



fenced stretches to prevent cattle menace, including a metal barrier fencing along the 623-km Mumbai- Ahmedabad train route.

Collapsible barriers

The NHAH guidelines recommend a slew of other measures to ensure road safety, including prohibiting openings in median walls on access-controlled highways. However, collapsible barriers at a dis-

life, patriotism, yoga, meditation, and environmental conservation. Describing youth as the most powerful force in shaping the future of the country, Mr. Nabin said after Independence, the country was often viewed from a regional or individual perspective, but now, with the mantra of *Sabka Saath, Sabka Vikas, Sabka Vishwas and Sabka Prayas*, 140 crore Indians have to move forward together in unity.

Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) national president Nitin Nabin on Monday stressed that youth power will shape the future and vision of a “Developed India by 2047” and called upon the young generation to contribute to nation building by associating themselves with the vision of a “Viksit Bharat”.

Addressing the *Yuva Samvad* programme in Meerut, the BJP chief said: "I urge the youth to contribute to nation building by associating themselves with the vision of a 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047 as envisaged by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. Your determination, study, experience, and patience are the foundations of success, every youth possesses immense energy, talent, and intellectual capacity, and if this strength is given the right direction, then the youth can take the country to new heights."

Shaping India's future

The National Highways Authority of India (NHAI) on Monday told the Chief Justice of India that it cannot herd stray cattle and animals off public thoroughfares and find them shelter homes.

In an oral mentioning before the Chief Justice Surya Kant, Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the NHAI, said the responsibility to discipline animals and cattle loitering on highways and roads, posing a danger to drivers, lay on the respective local authorities. The NHAI said compliance would entail expenditure of around ₹7,000 crore.

The law officer requested the CJI to constitute the Bench to facilitate the NHAI to make its request for a modification of the court's direction of November last year.

FAITH

Narada visits Valmiki

Valmiki Ramayana begins with Narada's visit to Valmiki's ashram. Narada was a distinguished sage and the son of Brahma. So, Valmiki asked him some questions. He listed 16 qualities and asked Narada who had all these qualities. But he laid down some conditions. The possessor of those qualities had to be alive at the time. He had to be living in bhuloka and he had to be a human being. The answer to Valmiki's question was obvious, because Lord Narayana had come to earth as a human being in the Rama avatara. Rama was in bhuloka at that time. Valmiki had Rama in mind when he put the question to Narada, said M.A. Venkatakrishnan in a discourse. Although he knew about Rama, he wanted to hear Narada talking about Him.

Instead of asking Narada directly to tell him about Rama, Valmiki asked him indirectly. When did this visit of Narada to Valmiki's ashram take place? It was when Rama was king of Ayodhya and Sita too was still there, not yet having been banished. Rama must have been between 40 and 45 years of age at that time. From the Valmiki Ramayana, we can infer that Rama was 12 when He married Sita. She must have been about six then. They were happily together in Ayodhya for 12 years. Rama had completed 24 years and was entering His 25th year, when He was banished. He spent 14 years in the forest. So, He must have been 39 when He returned. His coronation took place after His return to Ayodhya.

Narada met Valmiki in the latter's ashram on the banks of the Tamasa river. This place is near Kanpur, in Uttar Pradesh. But before Valmiki moved here, he had his ashram in Chitrakuta.

INBRIEF



NSE IPO gets nearly 4 times subscription on final day

The ₹22,569-crore initial public offering of the National Stock Exchange of India (NSE), the country's second-largest public issue, received 3.92 times subscription so far on the final day of bidding on Monday. The IPO received bids for 34.78 crore (34,78,26,096) shares against 8.86 crore (8,86,42,911) shares on offer, as per details available with BSE till 02:35 p.m. The category for Qualified Institutional Buyers (QIBs) garnered 7.99 times subscription. PTI

Elevate Campuses to raise ₹2,100 crore via IPO

Hillhouse Investment backed Elevate Campuses Ltd., an education platform owning, operating and managing on-campus student accommodations across private higher education institutions (HEIs) and K-12 assets, is planning to raise ₹2100 crore through an IPO at a price band of ₹343 to ₹362 per share with face value of ₹1. It will be the first student housing REIT type platform to be listed in India. Bids will open on September 23 and close on September 25. PTI

Money View to raise ₹1,092 crore through IPO

Digital lending service provider Money View Ltd. is planning to raise ₹1,092 crore through an initial public offer. The IPO comprises a fresh issue of shares worth ₹750 crore and the current owners diluting ₹342 crore of their stake. The company has fixed a price band of ₹32-34 a piece. Bids can be made for a minimum lot of 441 equity shares and multiples thereof. The IPO opens for subscription on September 24 and closes on September 28, 2026.

‘Critical mineral reuse issues being tackled’

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A whole-of-government approach is being followed to address issues concerning the recycling industry for critical minerals, G. Kishan Reddy, Union Mines Minister told the media on the sidelines of an event here.



G Kishan Reddy

“The issues [concerning the broader industry] are not just related to the Union Mines Ministry but to several other Ministries as well,” he stated, adding, “Discussions have been held with several Ministries with a whole of government approach, including electronics, finance, commerce and environment, among others,

and efforts are being made to address them.”

The Union Minister also assured his Ministry had taken note of recyclers’ demand for scrapping the mandatory Pre-Shipment Inspection Certificate (PSIC) and discussions would be held with the relevant Ministries to reach an amicable solution on the issue.

Report on reserves of Chilean copper blocks in 3 months: HCL

Mithun Dasgupta
KOLKATA



Anupam Misra

After four copper blocks in Chile were shortlisted for due diligence, State-run Hindustan Copper Ltd. (HCL) said work was underway on forming a joint-venture with Codelco, its Chilean strategic partner, to take it to the next level.

In an interview with *businessline*, HCL CMD Anupam Misra said the transaction advisor is likely to submit a report on the total reserves in these blocks in two to three months.

“Certain things are at the study stage at present. If any one of them is a mature block, it may take six to eight years to start production,” Mr. Misra said.

The firm, India’s only vertically-integrated copper producer, is exploring overseas resource opportunities via collaboration with Codelco, Chile’s state-owned copper mining firm, in an attempt to boost India’s long-term resource security.

‘Nearly 40% of coal power plants critically low on fuel’

The number of power plants with critically low coal stocks of less than 25% of the required inventory rose sharply to 74 as of September 19 from about 60 plants last week, data show

Reuters
NEW DELHI

Nearly 40% of India’s coal-fired power plants are operating with critically low fuel stocks due to a surge in power demand amid hotter-than-usual weather linked to El Niño, government data showed on Monday.

The number of power plants with critically low coal stocks of less than 25% of the required inventory or only able to generate power for less than three days rose sharply to 74 as of September 19 from about 60 plants last week, data from the Central Electricity Authority that is updated daily showed.

India’s peak power de-



Power struggle: India’s peak power demand has been hovering between 230 gigawatts and 250 gigawatts in the past week. REUTERS

mand, a measure of the maximum electricity requirement, has been hovering between 230 gigawatts and 250 gigawatts in the past week.

Peak power demand hit an all-time high of 270.70

gigawatts in May.

The decline in power plant stocks appears to be a temporary logistical issue rather than a sign of any structural supply constraints, Crisil analysts said. India’s coal and rail-

way ministries said in early September they were increasing supplies to the plants after erratic monsoon rains had impacted shipments.

Meanwhile, Indian power generation rose about 21% between April and August, but due to the intermittent nature of clean energy, coal-fired power continued to play a critical role in meeting round-the-clock demand, Crisil said.

Meanwhile, Indian power producers’ coal imports in August rose to a 15-month high as a heatwave boosted electricity demand while hydroelectric power generation remained subdued, prompting utilities to turn to costly overseas supplies, *Reuters* reported last week.

SP Group bonds offered at premium on Tata Sons stake-sale plan, bankers say

Reuters
MUMBAI

Deutsche Bank and other investors are offering rupee-denominated bonds of a Shapoorji Pallonji Group firm at a premium, encouraged by the group’s plans to sell part of its stake in Tata Sons, three merchant bankers said on Monday.

Tata Trusts, the con-

trolling shareholder in Tata Sons, last week said SP Group proposed to sell part of its stake worth ₹250 billion (\$2.61 billion).

Much-needed funds

That would give much-needed funds to the debt-laden infrastructure and construction conglomerate, the second-largest shareholder in Tata Sons.

SP Group entity Eqyizen

Investment had raised ₹213.50 billion through three-year zero-coupon bonds at a yield of 18.95% in July. The bonds are now being offered at a yield of around 18.70%-18.75%, the bankers said, requesting anonymity as they are not authorised to speak to the media.

Eqyizen’s bonds are secured by SP Group’s stake in Tata Sons. Held through Cyrus Invest-

ments. SP Group and Deutsche Bank, which structured the bond sale and was also a large investor in the issue, did not respond to *Reuters* requests for comment.

“Deutsche Bank has the bonds on its books and is actively seeking buyers to exit at some profit,” one of the bankers said.

“We have not seen major trades (yet).”

RBI ups FCNR(B) inflows to \$133 bn

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI

The special window for Non-Resident Indians (NRIs) to park funds in Indian banks through Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) or FCNR(B) deposits received an overwhelming response, attracting around \$133 billion in inflows at its closure on August 31.

As per Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data on September 21, FCNR(B) deposits accounted for the bulk of the dollar-denominated capital inflows into Indian banks. Overseas foreign currency borrowings and external commercial borrowings contributed \$5.3 billion each, taking the to-

tal inflow via these channels to \$143.6 billion as of August 31.

Easing rupee pressure

The scheme was unveiled by the RBI to support foreign exchange inflows and contain pressure on the rupee. RBI’s update on September 2 showed banks mobilised about \$127 billion via dollar-denominated FCNR(B) deposits.

The large inflows provided banks with a stable source of medium-term foreign currency funding at a time when lenders have been facing elevated credit-deposit ratios. However, S&P cautioned that the inflow surge is unlikely to be repeated at the same scale in the future.

UPI heads towards a code-less era, a decade after debut

Ashokamithran T.
MUMBAI



QR code is going to be a thing of the past.

A decade after the launch of the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), payment companies are moving towards a new phase of digital payments that seeks to make transactions faster and do away with one-time passwords (OTPs) and QR codes.

The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Governor last week launched a ‘tap and pay’ facility for UPI transactions in partnership with the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI), enabling payments through RuPay credit cards without the need for OTPs or QR codes.

The facility was unveiled at the Global Fintech Fest 2026 in Mumbai.

The new feature uses the point-of-sale (PoS) terminal’s internet connectivity, allowing a transaction to be completed even when the customer’s mobile device does not have internet access. NPCI said the facility is currently available for transactions of up to ₹5,000. For higher-value transactions, customers will have to enter their PIN.

UPI has emerged as India’s dominant electronic payment system, accounting for about 85% of transactions. Introduced in the aftermath of demonetisation, its rapid adoption has been driven largely by the convenience of making retail and utility payments without the need for cash.

However, the growing

scale of digital payments has also brought heightened concerns over fraud, including incidents involving the theft or inadvertent sharing of OTPs and other authentication credentials.

In response, the RBI mandated a two-factor authentication for UPI transactions from April 1, 2026, prompting payment companies to develop alternatives that combine security with ease of use.

Visa and Mastercard, for instance, have introduced passkeys as an additional authentication mechanism. Mastercard has also showcased its Consumer Device Cardholder Verification Method (CDCVM), which allows transactions to be authenticated through a device’s biometric capabilities, including fingerprint or facial recognition. Mastercard has partnered with Google Pay to offer the service.

Amazon Pay, which accounts for less than 1% of UPI transactions, has also introduced a tap-and-pay facility for its partner merchants as it seeks to expand its presence in the digital payments market.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Ms. Sonia Malik, D/o Late Sh. S. C. Sanan, an Overseas Citizen of India (OCI), is proposing to deal with the following properties, of which she is the absolute owner:

DDA Built-up Shop Nos. 7 and 4, situated at C-2C/II, DDA Market, Pankha Road, New Delhi, known as Janakpuri.

Any person having any right, title, interest, claim, objection, lien, charge, mortgage or encumbrance in respect of the said properties shall submit written objections, along with supporting documents, to the undersigned within 7 days from publication of this notice. Failing receipt thereof, the proposed transaction(s) shall proceed without further reference.

ARBITCONCLIA - CENTRE FOR DISPUTE RESOLUTION

Adv. Sudhir Gupta

E-mail: arbitconclia@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that Shri Ashwanil SSharma, S/o Late Shri C.L. Sharma, is proposing to deal with the following property:

Flat No. D-6/903, 9th Floor, Tower/Block D-3/Brunia, Saviour Park, Mohan Nagar, Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, admeasuring approximately 1,285 sq. ft. super area and 744.610 sq. ft. carpet area, acquired vide a registered Sale Deed before the Sub-Registrar-III, Ghaziabad.

Any person having any right, title, interest, claim, objection, lien, charge, mortgage or encumbrance in respect of the said property shall submit written objections, along with supporting documents, to the undersigned within 7 days from publication of this notice. Failing receipt thereof, the proposed transaction shall proceed without further reference.

For Mohan Law Chambers LLP

Kamna Sharma, Advocate

Email: mohanlawchambers@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE OF LOST DOCUMENT

Notice is hereby given that the Original Registered Sale Deed relating to property bearing Entire Built Up Property bearing New No.- D-56 (Old No.11), Land Area Measuring 200 Sq. Yds. i.e., 167.22 Sq. Mtrs., out of Khasra No. 58, Situated in the Abadi of Vikas Marg, Street n. 2, Vikas Marg, Laxmi Nagar, in the Area of Village Shakarpur Khas, Illaga Shahdra, Delhi- 110092, registered vide Document No. 2779, Book no.- 1, Volume no.- 1089 on pages 187 to 188, dated 19-03-1964, in the office of S.R.I, Delhi, has been lost/misplaced and is presently untraceable despite diligent search. Any person who finds the said document or has any information regarding its whereabouts is requested to contact the undersigned immediately. The general public is hereby cautioned that the aforesaid original Sale Deed shall not be misused, dealt with, transferred, pledged, mortgaged, or relied upon by any person without proper verification and authority from the undersigned.

Name: Rakesh Kumar Gupta

Address: D-56, Street No. 2, Vikas Marg, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi: 110092

Contact No.: 9999722720

Date: 07.09.2026

LEGAL NOTICE

THE CHIEF JUDICIAL MAGISTRATE COURT COIMBATORE

C.C. No. 2282 of 2021

The Assistant Commissioner of Customs, Coimbatore International Airports, Coimbatore.

... Complainant

-Vs-

1. S. Rahul Malik
1781, 2nd Floor,
Rani Bagh
Delhi-110 034.

2. S. Rakesh Kumar
E-21, Prathap Nagar,
New Delhi-110 007.

... Accused 1 & 2

The above-named accused have been prosecuted for offences punishable under Sections 135(1)(a) and 135(1)(b) of the Customs Act, 1962. Pursuant to the order dated 11.09.2026 passed by the Hon'ble Chief Judicial Magistrate, Coimbatore, this summons is being published through a newspaper.

Accordingly, the above-named accused, S. Rahul Malik and S. Rakesh Kumar, are hereby directed to appear before the Hon'ble Chief Judicial Magistrate Court, Coimbatore, on 30.10.2026 at 10:00 AM, either in person or through a duly authorized advocate, without fail.

Take notice that, in the event of failure to appear as directed, appropriate legal action shall be taken against them in accordance with law.

S/-

Dr. S.Balasubramanian.

Special Public Prosecutor

Customs, Central Excise, GST

Narcotics Control Bureau

Directorate of Revenue

Intelligence

Coimbatore

WHAT IT MEANS

This bronze medal is more than my life, says MMA fighter Suchika



R.V. MOORTHY

▲ This is more than my life. I will never forget that I came to Japan and got a medal for my country. I have played in Commonwealth Games (2022) in judo, where I missed the fight for bronze. So, I wanted to get a medal for India. I am also a world champion in Jiu-Jitsu — Traditional MMA 60kg bronze medallist Suchika Tariyal.

CAKEWALK

Deepika, Rutuja and Navneet do the trick as India routs Indonesia



SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

▲ Deepika Sehrawat, Rutuja Pisal and Navneet Kaur fired a hat-trick each as the Indian women's hockey team beat Indonesia 17-1 to register its second win in Pool B at the Asiad. Sunelita Toppo, Lalremsiami and Sakshi Rana scored a brace while Salima Tete and Ishika Chaudhary also struck. Innes Aditiya pulled one back.

FABULOUS FEAT

Savita becomes highest-capped Indian women's hockey player



FILE PHOTO

▲ Goalkeeper Savita Punia became the highest-capped Indian women's hockey player during the match against Indonesia at the Asian Games on Monday. The 36-year-old, who took the field for the 321st time at the international level, went past Vandana Katariya. Hockey India announced a cash award of ₹10 lakh for Savita.

GLOBAL GAME

'Never thought I'd be playing in Japan, shows cricket is picking up'



AFP

▲ I never thought about it, but yes, cricket is picking up in every country now, and all the teams are becoming dominant in their own way. This is the first time we'll be playing in Japan... and I don't know much about the conditions, but looking forward to the match — India captain Shreyas Iyer ahead of the Japan T20I.

Himanshu comes of age as marksmen get going

The youngster pips senior pro Rudrankksh to silver in 10m air rifle in a dramatic final; the two, along with Parth, also bag a silver in the team event; China's Sheng retains his individual title

ASIAN GAMES

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

India's wait for its first gold from the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games continued on the second day even as the shooters added three more medals to the tally, including a double podium finish in the 10m air rifle, here on Monday.

Himanshu Dhillon proved he was ready for the big stage, winning his maiden international individual medal at the senior level, pipping Rudrankksh Patil to a silver in a nail-biting, dramatic final that saw defending champion Sheng Lihao retain his title. The two, together with Parth Mane, also won silver as a team. India had won gold in the team event



Doing the country proud: Himanshu and Rudrankksh ensured a double podium finish for India.

R.V. MOORTHY

last time around with Rudrankksh the only constant. Himanshu, a week away from his 21st birth-

day, played a steady hand all through, staying in the top-three at all times with no signs of being a debu-

tant in the spotlight even as senior pro Rudrankksh and Sheng kept exchanging the lead at the top. Till



Impressive outing: Himanshu, Rudrankksh and Parth finished second behind China in the team event.

R.V. MOORTHY

the 15th shot, in fact, Rudrankksh was comfortably in the lead before Sheng crawled back even as Himanshu consolidated his spot. By the 17th shot, the potential medallists had been clearly identified with only the colour of the

metal to be decided. A 9.9 on the 18th by Himanshu sent the sizeable Indian presence in the stands into a tense silence before the youngster fought back with a couple of 10.5s.

It was on the 21st shot that the equations turned.

Himanshu managed an impressive 10.6 while Rudrankksh, in second position, could only manage a 9.7. It was the lowest score he had shot the whole day and it came at the worst possible time. It helped Himanshu leapfrog into se-

cond spot and even though the former found a 10.6 on his final shot, he fell agonisingly short by 0.1 points to finish third.

It was clear at that point that Sheng would walk away with the gold — he had built a two-point difference with two shots to go over Himanshu. But to the youngster's credit, he didn't give up. His final two shots were 10.8 and 10.9, as close to perfection as possible, but Sheng matched up for a new Games and Asian record of 254.2 points, bettering his own previously set mark of 253.3.

Earlier in the qualification, the Indian trio combined for a total of 1,890.1 points while Sheng, along with Ma Sihan and Zhang Changhong, totalled 1899 for China for a new World record, shadowing India's 1,893 three years earlier.

Wrestling was too hard: Himanshu on choosing shooting

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

As a State, Haryana typically evokes two distinct images — wrestling and shooting, the latter of a less-than-desirable kind. Himanshu Dhillon was expected to take up the first, carrying the family's and State's sporting tradition forward. He found his calling in the second instead, but one that brings fame and appreciation.

The 20-year-old, winning silver in his maiden senior international outing here, has the self-assured confidence that might seem cocky in others but for the region he comes from, is par for the course. "I am only happy when I win gold. My father always says gold is the only medal that counts; every silver is a gold lost. That thought has always been with me and that was my target here too. I had decided that even if I had to walk off after every shot to get my bearings right, I would do it but go for gold. Unfortunately, that didn't happen but I will keep trying till I get it," he declared after the 10m air rifle event on Monday.

It's a belief that has been

almost a decade in the making. Nephew of 2016 Rio Olympics Greco-Roman 98kg wrestler Hardeep Singh Dhillon, Himanshu as a chubby kid was initiated into the sport for fitness but could only last a few weeks. "Wrestling was too hard," he shrugged. His father got him enrolled into Gurukul Pundri in Kaithal to make him independent and that's where the shooting bug bit him.

"When I started, every time I would collapse on the mat, I would wonder what I had got myself into. But now it finally feels like I did the right thing, that the decision to get into shooting was not a mistake," he laughed.

The never-say-die attitude also comes to the fore when talking about the battle with senior teammate Rudrankksh Patil for the colour of the medal. "I knew I could have taken it a little easy after the top-three were decided, that at least a bronze was confirmed. But I was not ready to give up. I kept thinking that the colour of the medal could still change, that I could maybe shoot a perfect score and the others might slip up," he said.



On target: Himanshu landed his maiden international medal at the senior level. R.V. MOORTHY



Suchika... bitter-sweet bronze.

R.V. MOORTHY

Unkindest cut of all for Suchika

Press Trust of India
NAGOYA

Suchika Tariyal settled for a bronze medal in the women's Traditional Mixed Martial Arts 60kg event of the Asian Games here on Monday as Singapore's Hui Hoon Teo was awarded the semifinal win on account of her lower weight after the two fighters drew the gruelling bout.

A first

This was India's maiden medal in the discipline that made its debut at the 20th edition of the Games.

Suchika, however, was shattered by the result and wept on the mat once the final decision was announced.

The bout was initially ruled in Teo's favour but after an Indian challenge, the result was declared a draw, and the winner was then determined by the fighters' morning weights.

The 700-gram margin

"Since the Singaporean was lighter than Suchika by around 700 grams, she moved to the final. Suchika settled for bronze," MMA Sports Federation president Nikhil Kunde said.

India and Sri Lanka tussle in yet another continental title clash

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Nine days after facing off for continental dominance in the Asia Cup final in faraway Dubai, India and Sri Lanka will once again meet in another title clash, this time at the Asian Games here on Tuesday.

The defending champion will look to extend its seven-match winning streak against Lanka in a repeat of the final from three years ago in Hangzhou, and will enter the contest at the Korogi Athletics Park in Nisshin as the strong favourite on both form and ranking.

Both teams are unbeaten in the competition. While India thrashed Bangladesh by 114 runs in the semifinal, Lanka had to fall back on captain Chamari Athapaththu's 50-ball 83 to get over the line in a tricky chase against Pakistan in the other last-four clash.

India's openers have been in excellent form, with Shafali Verma getting her maiden T20I century (100 n.o., 49b) against Bangladesh.

Smriti Mandhana and Harmanpreet Kaur have also been among the runs, but beyond them and Shafali, things have not been rosy.

G. Kamalini and Bharti Fulmali haven't fired yet and will want to make it count when it matters the most.

Given a choice, the Women in Blue would look to bat first and get a big total to put Sri Lanka under pressure, just like they did in the Asia Cup earlier this month.

On the bowling front, India's spin attack, led by Deepti Sharma and the impressive Shree Charani, is



Start and finish: India will expect fireworks from Shafali and Richa.

FILE PHOTO: R.V. MOORTHY

THE INDIA SHOW

▼ A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Monday:

Badminton: Men's team (round-of-16): bt Bangladesh 3-0.

Boxing: Men's 70kg (round-of-32): Sumit bt Bunjong (Tha).

Hockey: Women (Pool B): bt Indonesia 17-1.

Kabaddi: Men (Group A): bt Japan 49-24; Women (Group A): bt Bangladesh 42-21.

Mixed Martial Arts: Women's Traditional -60kg: Semifinal: Suchika drew with Hoon (Sgp), lost on weight rule and bagged bronze.

Shooting: Men (final): 10m air rifle individual: Himanshu (silver), Rudrankksh (bronze); Team: Silver (Himanshu, Parth,

Rudrankksh); Skeet individual qualification (day 1): Anantjeet (21st), Mairaj (26th), Bhavtegh (27th); Women: Skeet individual qualification (day 1): Raiza (ninth), Parinaaz (14th), Maheshwari (16th).

Swimming: Men: 50m backstroke: Srihari (10th in the final), Rishabh (11th overall), DNQ for final; 50m freestyle: Akash (26th overall) and Heer (28th overall), DNQ for final; 100m breaststroke: Danush (22nd overall), DNQ for final; 4x200m freestyle relay: Ninth overall, DNQ for final.

Table tennis: Women's team (Group F): bt Pakistan 3-0; Men's team (Group F): bt Pakistan 3-0.

Wushu: Women's Changquan final: Wangsu (15th).

expected to be the key.

As the only one who was part of the side last time around, Deepti would be keen on getting another gold but Chamari's return to form with the bat should make the Indians wary.

The weather has been overcast for a couple of

days now, and while there is no forecast of rain yet, things can change overnight.

In case the final gets washed out, India would be declared winner as the higher-ranked team.

Match starts at 10.30 a.m. IST.

SNAPSHOTS

▼ **Indian kabaddi teams begin title defence in style**

TOKAI CITY: Defending champions Indian men's and women's kabaddi teams made winning starts to their Asian Games campaign with thumping victories over Japan and Bangladesh, respectively, here on Monday. The Indian men began their title defence with a resounding 49-24 win over Japan.

Later, the Indian women's team brushed aside the challenge from Bangladesh 42-21. The men are placed in Group A alongside Japan, South Korea, Taiwan and Bangladesh. They will face South Korea on Tuesday. The women are in Group A along with Iran, Japan and Bangladesh, and will next play Iran.

Indian TT teams score 3-0 wins over Pakistan, reach pre-quarterfinals
TOYOTA: The India women's and men's table tennis teams advanced to the Asian Games



Sutirtha. FILE PHOTO: SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

pre-quarterfinals after identical 3-0 wins over their Pakistan rivals on Monday.

At the Sky Hall here, the women's contingent topped Group F with its third win in a row while the men's side bounced back with the same scoreline, also in Group F. **The results: Women (Group F): India bt Pakistan 3-0** (Sutirtha Mukherjee bt Aleena Khan 11-3, 11-3, 11-4; Syndrela Das bt Kalsoom Khan 11-6, 11-7, 11-5; Sreeja Akula bt Fatima Khan 11-4, 11-5).

Men (Group F): India bt Pakistan 3-0 (Harmeet Desai bt Muhammad Khan 11-4, 11-3, 11-5; G. Sathian bt Abbas Khan 11-1, 11-8, 11-9; Payas Jain bt Taimur Khan 11-2, 11-5, 11-7).

INDIANS IN ACTION TODAY

▼ A look at some Indian players/teams who will compete on Tuesday (all times IST):

Badminton: Women's team (quarterfinal): vs. Japan, 6 a.m.; Men's team (quarterfinal): vs. Japan, 11.30 a.m.

Boxing: Round-of-32: Women (from 8.30 a.m.): 51kg: Sakshi vs. Villegas (Phi); Men (from 1.30 p.m.): 55kg: Jadumani vs. Bahadur (Nep).

Cricket: Women's final: vs. Sri Lanka, 10.30 a.m.

Equestrian: Eventing (Fouaad, Arjan, Ashish): Individual and team dressage, 5.45 a.m.; Individual and team jumping, noon.

Fencing: Men's foil individual (Hemash, Sachin), 6.30 a.m. onwards; Women's epee individual (Mitva, Taniksha), 8.15

a.m. onwards.

Hockey: Men (Pool A): vs. Sri Lanka, 3.30 p.m.

Kabaddi: Men (Group A): vs. South Korea, 7.15 a.m.

Shooting: 10m air rifle mixed team qualification (Elavenil & Parth), 6.15 a.m.; final, 8.25 a.m.; Skeet individual qualification and team final (day 2): Men: Mairaj, Anantjeet, Bhavtegh (6.30 a.m.); Women: Parinaaz, Raiza, Maheshwari (6.30 a.m.).

Swimming: Men: 1500m freestyle - Final B (Aryan), 7.30 a.m.; 4x100m medley relay: Heats (from 8 a.m.), final (2.55 p.m.).

Table tennis: Women's team (round-of-16): vs. Thailand, 6.30 a.m.

Wushu: Women's Nanquan & Nandao final: Langlengtombi, 6.30 a.m. & noon.



R.V. MOORTHY

Rudrankksh — Indian shooting’s ‘chosen one’

The 22-year-old, who clinched bronze in 10m air rifle at the Aichi-Nagoya Asian Games, has overcome a dark phase with constant learning and determination; the versatile shooter hopes to ‘complete the set’ at the 2028 Olympics

Uthra Ganesan
NAGOYA

Three years ago, Rudrankksh Balasaheb Patil was being spoken of, in hushed but awed tone, as a possible successor to Abhinav Bindra.

The then 19-year-old’s performances and consistency had evoked admiration and hope in the shooting fraternity. But it all came crashing when he stumbled, finishing fourth in 10m air rifle at the 2023 Asian Games and failing to make the cut for the Paris Olympics – a quota he had held on to for two years after becoming the first Indian shooter to earn one. It wasn’t his skill that let him down; it was the mind. Still only 22, Rudrankksh is now a lot more in control – of his mind, emotions, thoughts. That control saw him go one better on his disappointing Hangzhou outing, winning a bronze medal in 10m air rifle in Aichi-Nagoya.

Most importantly, the teenaged nervous energy has been replaced by a quietly confident one, a belief that he is good enough to succeed in not one but two events. He is representing India in both 10m air rifle and 50m rifle 3-Positions, the latter an addition after the Paris heartbreak in 2024.

Getting inspired

“As I see it, there are only a couple of athletes in the world who are doing well in two events. There are a lot of myths around balancing the two. When I started, there was a belief that if you do a second event, it will destroy your 10m form. There is also a thought that it’s difficult to manage both.

“But I was told by my nutritionist and psychologist that as long as you have two working legs and two working hands, you can do multiple events. That inspired me. And I saw Michael Phelps, who participated in multiple events and won multiple medals in all of them. So why not me? I have age on my side. I have a lot of years to make mistakes and learn through them,” the bespectacled youngster said in an exclusive interaction with *The Hindu* during the preparatory camp in Bhopal.

“This is the first Asian Games where I am participating in two events. It’s my fourth international competition doing so. Every time, I have improved a little bit. I have good coaches, good support staff. There is a lot of motivation. The hunger and greed is intact: if anything, it’s grown,” he added.

Content with third place

He has definitely learned. The bronze, which he clinched in 10m air rifle after leading for almost 70% of the competition here on Monday, might have been a disappointment at another time but for someone who has been in this position before, a medal was more than welcome.

“I am very happy with bronze because a lot of things could have gone wrong but all of it ended well. I would like to see the positives rather than the negatives,” he said.

Tough times

The aftermath of missing out on an Olympic outing was big, but for those around him more than himself. He hadn’t done badly: he finished third behind Arjun Babuta and Sandeep Singh in the trials.

“The sad part was seeing my parents and support staff. I was fine, honestly. My initial thought was: ‘I competed in 13 events and won 11. It’s just this one match that I lost, not a big deal’. But when I realised everyone was looking forward to that one match and were sad after watching me work hard, I was affected.

“I was actually sad because all the hard work which I had put in did not yield the result. But then, I started seeing the facts. It’s not that I was not selected because my score was bad: it was because one person shot a really high score. And I could not compete with that. Secondly, I always evaluate what I could have done better after a competition... the mistakes I made. But after that, I had nothing. I had given my best, my everything. I was able to figure things out and move forward.

“I started in a new event. My way of taking a break was getting back to shooting but it was on my terms. I used to go to the range but with no set schedule. I trained as I liked, whenever or however I liked... sometimes for hours, sometimes maybe for just 15 to 20 minutes. It was just a part of my life in which I had to be patient, I had to be persistent. I gradually built up my love for the sport again and started enjoying it,” Rudrankksh explained the dark phase.

Finishing the job

There is also a determination to see his dreams, hard work and journey through to the end. It’s something that drives him, considering that the fear of leaving things midway has happened far too often for comfort.

“When I started my sporting journey, I was not exactly in a happy space in life. My marks (academics) were just fine. I was not good in other sports, I was new to the city and did not have many friends, I was lagging in everything. My parents used to get me some mechanical or Lego sets and I never completed any.

“It was a recurring complaint from my teachers that I was not completing anything. It became an obsession for me, it became a fixation that I want to do something in my life. I want to complete something. I started seeing athletes all over... Phelps. I had watched Bindra sir’s 2016 Olympics in Rio. All those sparked something in me. Even now, whenever things are not working out, I look around me for inspiration.

“A lot of athletes show up every day. Manu Bhaker, who is always on time, everywhere, always in the gym no matter what. Maybe, someone some day is as inspired by me as I am by others. That thought keeps me alive, gives me hope.”

He has learnt to stop worrying about things not in his control. Call it fate or luck, but Rudrankksh prefers calling himself the ‘chosen one’ for all the unexpected setbacks he has faced, many of them not of his making. “I am kind of used to it by now. Even today (Monday), after my match was done, I picked up my rifle and the strap of the case broke. At the Peru World Cup, my gun auto-fired in the final and I was eliminated. Only my visa gets rejected,” he shrugged.

Showing maturity

The nervous, high-strung energy has settled into a quieter rhythm. It had helped him perform back then but had taken a toll on his health, both physical and mental. He suffered an auto-immune condition triggered by stress, messed up his sleep cycle and was desperate to continue regardless of everything – a lot like being on a high without drugs.

“When I lost, I would be down in the dumps. When I won, I used to feel like wanting to continue the streak no matter what – whether my sleep was affected, my hands were shaking, I was tired and ready to drop dead. Nothing mattered, only winning did. It has changed now but I am still learning how my body works. I learnt that fatigue is something which builds up during the Olympic time. I know I need to be more strategic and dissociated from the results.”

He knows he will make mistakes. He also knows that he will keep learning from them. Like Monday, when he admitted that slipping from No. 1 to No. 3 was largely his own doing – a poor 9.7 shot dashed his golden hopes.

“This gives me a kick, reminding me that I need to be calm till the last moment. I was too excited for the shot and I released before calming down. I think all the accumulated things over the last six months... perhaps it was just the way the body reacted once a medal was confirmed. The last time I spoke to you, I said I was looking to improve my rank, and that’s exactly what happened. Perhaps I need to watch what comes out of my mouth the next time,” he quipped.

External support

The support from the system has played a big role in his growth in 50m 3P. “The TOPS CEO then (Cmdr. P.K. Garg) was very supportive. He sanctioned my trip to Serbia for training with Olympic medallist Milenko Sebic. And he was impressed. The National coaches guided me on the right equipment, ammunition suppliers and provided the shots. Everything came together and in 2025, I participated in my first trials. I was in top-10, then top-6, now top-3. I hope to continue this.”

He is also aware that there is a long way to go. Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar, who beat him in the shoot-off for the 10m bronze medal in Hangzhou, is the top guy in 50m 3P. While Rudrankksh insists that there is no rivalry between the two, he is clear on the strengths of both.

“I don’t and can’t compare myself with him in 3P because he is the best in the country for the past seven to eight years. This year, I was able to play with

him in three international tournaments: my aim every time was to score around 587 points while he shot above 590 in all. I don’t compare myself with him in 10m because I feel I am better. I have proved myself in it more than him and I have been in the 10m team for as long as he’s been in 3P. But yes, there are times when he shoots 10m better than everyone. In fact, he is also one of my inspirations to try two events – if he can do it, why can’t I?”

The Asian Games will help him complete the first set of targets he has set for himself, a list that, by his own admission, has grown in reverse. From being crowned the World champion in 10m air rifle in his maiden senior international outing in 2022 to winning his first National title earlier this year, Rudrankksh’s journey has been interesting, to say the least.

“I won the World championship, then the World Cup Final, World Cups, got the World No. 1 title, the World Record. This year, I won the Asian championship for the first time after finishing fourth repeatedly. The only regret is that despite all this, I have not even been considered for an Arjuna Award so far. I even won my first National-level tournament this year. But there is the Olympics to complete the set, maybe they will recognise after that,” he signed off.



There is determination to see his dreams, hard work and journey through to the end. It’s something that drives him, considering that the fear of leaving things midway has happened far too often



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THE GIST

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